



Source and provide destination information and advice

D2.TTA.CL2.19

Trainee Manual



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Trainee Manual



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The Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) was established on 8 August 1967. The Member States of the Association are Brunei Darussalam, Cambodia, Indonesia, Lao PDR, Malaysia, Myanmar, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand and Viet Nam.

The ASEAN Secretariat is based in Jakarta, Indonesia.

General Information on ASEAN appears online at the ASEAN Website: www.asean.org.

All text is produced by William Angliss Institute of TAFE for the ASEAN Project on "Toolbox Development for Tourism Labour Divisions for Travel Agencies and Tour Operations".

This publication is supported by the Australian Government's aid program through the ASEAN-Australia Development Cooperation Program Phase II (AADCP II).

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File name: TM_Source_&_provide_destination_info_advice_270415



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Introduction to trainee manual

To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT/CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainees chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his/her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service
- Front Office

- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he/she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and/or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and/or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.

Unit descriptor

Source and provide destination information and advice

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Source and provide destination information and advice in a range of settings within the travel industries workplace context.

Unit Code:

D2.TTA.CL2.19

Nominal Hours:

50

Element 1: Generate initial destination knowledge

Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Identify sources of destination information
- 1.2 Describe criteria for capturing destination information
- 1.3 Identify client needs relating to destination information that may be required
- 1.4 Research destination information
- 1.5 Capture and record and classify destination and general destination information

Element 2: Update destination knowledge

Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Register to receive updated destination information
- 2.2 Integrate updated information into existing destination information
- 2.3 Initiate new files for new information and/or new destinations

Element 3: Communicate destination knowledge

Performance Criteria

- 3.1 Identify client and colleague needs relating to destination information that is required
- 3.2 Share destination information
- 3.3 Advise clients in relation to information about specific destinations
- 3.4 Present hard copy information to clients

Element 4: Review provision of destination knowledge

Performance Criteria

- 4.1 Evaluate sources of destination information
- 4.2 Evaluate methods of provision of destination information
- 4.3 Evaluate effectiveness of destination information provision
- 4.4 Amend or confirm sources of destination information

Assessment matrix

Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance - Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 1: Generate initial destination knowledge				
1.1	Identify sources of destination information	1.1	1,2	1
1.2	Describe criteria for capturing destination information	1.2	3,4	2
1.3	Identify client needs relating to destination information that may be required	1.3	5,6,7,8	3,4
1.4	Research destination information	1.4	9,10,11,12	5
1.5	Capture and record and classify destination and general destination information	1.5	14	6
Element 2: Update destination knowledge				
2.1	Register to receive updated destination information	2.1	13	7
2.2	Integrate updated information into existing destination information	2.2	15,16	8
2.3	Initiate new files for new information and/or new destinations	2.3	17	9
Element 3: Communicate destination knowledge				
3.1	Identify client and colleague needs relating to destination information that is required	3.1	5,6,7,8	3,4
3.2	Share destination information	3.2	18,19	10
3.3	Advise clients in relation to information about specific destinations	3.3	20,21	11
3.4	Present hard copy information to clients	3.4	22,23	12

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 4: Review provision of destination knowledge				
4.1	Evaluate sources of destination information	4.1	24,25,26	13
4.2	Evaluate methods of provision of destination information	4.2	27,28	14
4.3	Evaluate effectiveness of destination information provision	4.3	27,28	15
4.4	Amend or confirm sources of destination information	4.4	29,30	16

Glossary

Term	Explanation
Analyse	To examine in detail in order to discover meaning, essential features
Assumption	A calculated guess
Auxiliary destinations and services	Any destination or service that supports the travel experience including travel insurance, currency and banking, visas, merchandise etc.
Compliance	To meet the requirements of
CRS	Computer Reservations system
Customer	Any person who is paying for a destination or service provided
Data	Individual facts, statistics, or items of information
Database	A collection of information that is organized so that it can easily be accessed, managed, and updated
Feedback	A reaction or response
Findings	Conclusions based on calculated thought
GDS	Global Distribution System
GPS	Global Positioning System
Inbound Tour Wholesaler	Packages destinations to form a trip for an overseas market travelling to a specific country
Information systems	Software package that is used to collect data and translate it into useful information
Initiatives	An introductory act or step; leading action
Interpret	To give or provide the meaning of; explain; explicate
Issues	A topic of importance
Itinerary	A planned route or journey
Objectives	Something that one's efforts or actions are intended to attain or accomplish; purpose; goal; target

Term	Explanation
Outbound Tour Wholesaler	Negotiates destination from International Suppliers for clients in a specific travelling to an international destination
Phonetic alphabet	A set of words used to stand for the letters of an alphabet in oral communication
Policy	A rule or statement
Procedure	A step by step instruction on how a specific incident or activity should be conducted
Destination information inventory	A database used for storing and administering all types of destination information data
Destination	Anything that can be offered to a market that might satisfy a want or need.
Quotation	A document stating all requested information relating to a travel destination and service including inclusions, costs and considerations
Service	Intangible offering that adds to the travel experience
Statistics	The study of the collection, analysis, interpretation, presentation, and organization of data
Testimonial	Formal statement testifying the characteristics of an organisation
Tour operator	Organises sightseeing tours and accommodation in a particular destination or region
Tourism board	Coordinate the efforts of hotels, airlines and travel agents to develop the tourism industry of the country

Element 1:

Generate initial destination knowledge

1.1 Identify sources of destination information

Introduction

The tourism industry is one of the largest industries in the world and for many countries is its major economy and employer. Tourism has become a very significant global activity and as disposable income and the ease of travel continue to grow, so will the industry.

Destination knowledge is a vital pre-requisite for effective performance within the industry.

There are many sources of information that can assist you. Some of these sources are generic in nature and others are specific to the industry.

The idea of obtaining destination information is so that you can use it for:

- Your benefit
- The benefit of the venue
- The ultimate benefit of the customers.



Importance of having updated destination information



Developing and maintaining destination information is a very important element of providing excellent levels of customer service in the tourism industry.

All tourism establishments will be expected to provide accurate destination information to their customers.

The level and nature of the destination information will differ between customers, however all tourism staff must have a wide range of destination knowledge at their disposal to meet the informational needs of their customers.

Whilst no-one expects everyone to know everything there is to know about all the tourism options that may exist, all staff must have at least substantial general tourism knowledge but also know where to source information in a timely manner.

Depending on your industry sector and role, you may be expected to:

- Provide destination information and advice to all types of customers
- Provide specific destination advice to all types of customers
- Sell tourism destinations to the customer
- Quote specific individual tourism destination prices
- Book and coordinate tourism supplier services for the customer
- Participate in destination launches and explain the features of the destinations.



There are endless sources of destination information that can be collected, analysed and used by a travel and tourism organisation for the benefit of the organisation itself or to assist customers with potential travel plans.

Sources of destination information



When compiling destination information for your data bases, it is essential to identify the different types of businesses in which your potential customers may use.

Whilst gathering information from every potential tourism operator is impossible and impractical, identifying commonly used tourism providers enables you to gather information relating to the destinations and services they provide.

In addition it enables you to ensure that the information that you have gathered is accurate and up to date.

Depending on the types of tourism offerings provided by your organisation possible businesses in which you may seek destination information from includes, but not limited to:

- Airlines
- Other travel suppliers
- Suppliers
- Accommodation
- Attractions and theme parks
- Tour operators
- Inbound Tour Wholesaler
- Outbound Tour Wholesale
- Retail Travel Agents
- Local, regional and National information services
- Meetings and Events
- Corporate Agents
- Ministries of Tourism
- Tourism boards
- Industry authorities and associations.



Airlines

Airlines own the planes and sell seats to all sectors in the travel industry. They do this via Computer Reservations systems (CRS) such as Galileo, Sabre and Amadeus.

They also sell seats via the Internet and via the phone to the public. Airlines negotiate rates with Retail Agents, Wholesalers, and Corporate Agents who then take a commission from the airline sale. Some Airlines have a Wholesale division which sells directly to Retail agents.



Other travel suppliers

These include but are not limited to:

- Cruise operators
- Railway operators
- Bus lines
- Car rental businesses
- Limousine hire
- Taxis.



Suppliers and providers of support and ancillary services

This includes:

- Travel insurance providers
- Finance providers
- Currency exchange
- Conference and similar venues
- Interpreters.

Accommodation

This sector includes but not limited to:

- Hotels and motels
- Guest houses
- Bed and breakfasts
- Caravan parks and camping grounds
- Resorts
- Time share properties
- Apartments, villas and cottages
- Conference and exhibition centres.



Attractions and Theme Parks

This sector includes but not limited to:

- Museums and galleries
- National parks, wildlife parks and gardens
- Theme parks
- Heritage sites and centres
- Sport and activity centres
- Aquarium and zoos.



Tour Operators

A tour operator typically organises sightseeing tours and accommodation in a particular destination or region. They act as a middle person between the Wholesaler and the Principal or Supplier of the destination

Examples of businesses include Trafalgar Tours and Contiki.

Visit:

- www.trafalgartours.com
- www.contiki.com.



Inbound Tour Wholesaler

An Inbound Tour Wholesaler packages destinations to form a trip for an overseas market travelling to a specific country.

Outbound Tour Wholesaler

An Outbound Tour Wholesaler negotiates destination from International Suppliers for clients in a specific travelling to an international destination. They approach airlines, hotel, local tour operators, cruise companies, car rental companies and rail companies to obtain wholesale rates which are then on-sold to the public via the Retail Travel Agents

Examples of businesses include Tempo Holidays, Peregrine Adventures and Creative.

Visit:

- www.tempoholidays.com
- www.peregrineadventures.com
- www.creativeholidays.com.



Retail Travel Agents

A Retail Travel agent is the go-between between the client and the Wholesaler. It is the Retail agent who obtains all the relevant details from a client to enable them to make a booking through a Wholesaler. All this information is then finalised and paid for to the Wholesaler. Both the Retail agent and the Wholesaler make commission from the booking.

Examples of these businesses include: Flight Centre, STA and American Express.

Visit:

- www.harveyworld.com
- www.flightcentre.com
- www.statravel.com.



Local, regional and national information services



These information services exist to assist the public and Travel agents in obtaining information on a particular region from the experts. This can be at a local, regional or national level.

These bureaux can be independent bodies or come under the support and direction of the respective Ministries of Tourism, which will be identified later.

These bureaux take calls from Travel agents as well as the public to help in promoting their region. They have wholesale divisions and all staff are experts in their area.

All these locally based Tourist bureaux have a fantastic website with a wealth of information and destinations to extend one's knowledge.

At a regional level there may be Information Centres, which provides a local booking service for accommodation in the area. They also provide pamphlets on local attractions which inform visitors of points of interest in the area.

Meetings and Events

This sector has been one of the fastest growing within the tourism and hospitality industry.

These companies organise meetings, conferences and major events by booking flights, accommodation, tours and the meeting facilities for their Client and their guests.



Large Corporate Companies have a separate department set up specifically to cater for the conference and event market. An example of this type of Company is HRG (Hogg Robinson Group) which is a UK based company specialising in corporate travel and having a division specifically setup for conference and event bookings.

There are also independent companies that only specialise in Meetings and Events, such as The Event Factory and C1 Events.

Ministries of Tourism

Each country within the ASEAN region will have dedicated government ministry specifically focused on the tourism industry. Their role is to regulate and manage the industry.

A Ministry of Tourism is usually responsible for the formulation of national policies and programmes and for the co-ordination of activities of various governments and the private Sector for the development and promotion of tourism in the country.

The Ministry may co-ordinate special initiatives including:

- Selecting and managing heritage sites
- Dedication and allocation of government funding to tourism initiatives
- Providing information on news laws and regulations
- Establishing service excellence awards
- Publishing and managing tenders for tourism projects.

The ASEAN region, whilst working collectively to achieve a primary purpose of attracting tourism to the region as a whole, each participating government will also have their own websites and departments in which to collect information. They have been identified below.

BRUNEI

Tourism Development Division

Ministry of Industry and Primary Resources

Jln. Menteri Besar, Bandar Seri Begawan, Brunei Darussalam

Tel. (673-2) 382822 Fax. (673-2) 382824

Email: info@bruneitourism.travel

Website: <http://www.bruneitourism.travel/>

CAMBODIA

Ministry of Tourism

3, Preah Monivong Blvd, Phnom Penh, Cambodia

Tel. (855-23) 213911 Fax. (855-23) 426107/217503

Email: dgpro@camnet.com.kh

Website: <http://www.tourismcambodia.com/>

INDONESIA

Ministry of Culture and Tourism

Jl. Medan Merdeka Barat 17, Jakarta 10110, Indonesia

Tel. (62-21)3838157 Fax. (62-21) 3849715

Website:

<http://www.budpar.go.id>

<http://www.my-indonesia.info>

LAOS

National Tourism Authority of Lao P.D.R.

Lane Xang Avenue, P.O. Box 3556, Vientiane, Lao P.D.R.

Tel. (856-21) 212248 Fax. (856-21) 212769/2127910

Website: <http://www.tourismlaos.gov.la/>



MALAYSIA

Ministry of Tourism

Menara Dato' Onn

Putra World Trade Center, 50480, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

Tel. (603) 2693 5188 Fax. (603) 269 0207/2693 0884

Email: tourism@tourism.gov.my

Website: <http://www.tourism.gov.my>

MYANMAR

Ministry of Hotels and Tourism

No. 77-91, Sule Pagoda Road, Yangon, Myanmar

Tel. (95-1) 285689 Fax. (95-1) 289588/254417

Email: dht.mht@myanmar.com.mm /

mtt.mht@mptmail.net.mm

Website: <http://www.myanmar-tourism.com/>

<http://www.hotel-tourism.gov.mm>

<http://www.myanmar.com/Ministry/Hotel-Tour>

<http://www.myanmars.net/mtt>

<http://www.myanmar-tourismboard.com/>

**PHILIPPINES**

Department of Tourism

DOT Building, T.M. Kalaw Street, Agrifina Circle, Rizal Park

Manila 10004, Philippines

Tel. (632) 523 8411 Fax. (632) 521 7374

Email: deptour@info.com.ph

Website: <http://www.wowphilippines.com.ph/>

SINGAPORE

Singapore Tourism Board

Tourism Court, 1 Orchard Spring Lane, Singapore 247729

Tel. (65) 736 6622 Fax. (65) 736 9423

Email: stb_sog@stb.gov.sg

Website: <http://www.yoursingapore.com/>

**THAILAND**

Tourism Authority of Thailand

1600 New Phetchaburi Road

Makkasan, Ratchathewi, Bangkok 10400, Thailand

Tel. (662) 250 5500 Fax. (662) 253 7437

Email: center@tat.or.th

Website: <http://www.tourismthailand.org>



VIET NAM

Viet Nam National administration of Tourism

80 Quan Su Street, Hanoi, Viet Nam

Tel. (84-4) 822 8744 Fax. (84-4) 942 4115

Email: binhvnat@hn.vnn.vn

Website: <http://www.vietnamtourism.com>

Tourism Boards



In some countries such as in Singapore, a 'tourism board' has been established. It is called the Singapore Tourism Board. From its inception the primary task of STB was to coordinate the efforts of hotels, airlines and travel agents to develop the fledgling tourism industry of the country.

Later, the STB began to initiate new marketing ideas to promote Singapore's image abroad. The board created the Merlion, a symbol based on a Singapore mythical legend that

became an icon of the Singapore destination. The board also has been providing travel agent licensing and tourist guide training.

STB actively promotes the development of infrastructure, including the building of hotels and tourist attractions such as the Jurong Bird Park and Sentosa which is now a popular resort island for both tourists and local visitors. The board also markets the city as a convention venue and organises events to attract visitors.

Industry Authorities

Authorities are established, either by a government or working closely with government to provide services relating to the tourism industry.

One such example is the 'Tourism Authority of Thailand –

<http://www.tourismthailand.org/about-thailand/>

It is the official travel information website for tourists visiting Thailand and contains all information to ensure visitors have all the necessary information to help them plan and enjoy their travel experience.

Industry Associations

Industry associations are bodies that all businesses can elect to join that serve specific and over-arching industry sectors. These bodies provide businesses with a variety of services which can include:

- Representing the industry – this means they act as an industry spokesperson to unions, the media and government
- Legal advice – about industrial relations issues, OH&S
- Training – to management and operational staff
- Industry standards and benchmarks – which member bodies can elect to implement as their standard practice
- Cost savings – by virtue of establishing for their members a range of discount rates for destinations and services from industry suppliers.



Sources of destination information

Activity 1

For each source of destination information listed below, provide examples of actual organisations in which you would request information from.



Sources of destination information	Names of organisations
Airlines	
Other travel suppliers	
Cruise operators	
Railway operators	
Bus lines	
Car rental businesses	
Limousine hire / taxis	

Sources of destination information	Names of organisations
Travel insurance providers	
Finance providers	
Currency exchange	
Conference and similar venues	
Interpreters	
Accommodation	
Hotels and motels	
Guest houses	
Bed and breakfasts	

Sources of destination information	Names of organisations
Caravan parks and camping grounds	
Resorts	
Time share properties	
Apartments, villas and cottages	
Conference and exhibition centres	
Attractions and theme parks	
Museums and galleries	
National parks, wildlife parks and gardens	
Theme parks	
Heritage sites and centres	

Sources of destination information	Names of organisations
Sport and activity centres	
Aquarium and zoos	
Tour operators	
Inbound Tour Wholesaler	
Outbound Tour Wholesale	
Retail Travel Agents	
Local, regional and National information services	
Meetings and Events	
Corporate Agents	

Sources of destination information	Names of organisations
Ministries of Tourism	
Tourism boards	
Industry authorities	
Industry associations	



Formats of destination information

Whilst the sources of information that can help identify possible tourism products and services that will be helpful in preparing quotations for customers is limitless, possible sources of information are identified below.

Information sources	What sort of information can you find here?
Brochures/DVDs	Destinations and product information, packages, prices, booking conditions. Many brochures also provide information on local customs, health precautions, visa requirements, currency, shopping, hints on what to wear.
Hotel and accommodation guides and indexes	Information and contacts on accommodation.
Atlases, maps and encyclopaedias	Geographical and general destinations information.
Travel guides	Destination and product information. (e.g. Lonely Planet, Fodor's, Insight, internet)
Individual timetables	Product and scheduling information, general industry information.
Automated information systems	Varied information
Computerised Reservations Systems (CRS)	Almost anything relating to airlines-flight schedules, fares, seating plans, just to name a few. In addition, most CRSs can provide you with a massive amount of other information – location times, daily exchange rates, visa information, destination information. They also provide a link into the reservations systems of many wholesalers.
International airline guides	Comprehensive worldwide air schedules, minimum connecting times, check in requirements, baggage information, airline and city codes, international time calculators, local taxes etc. The main example is the Official Airline Guide (OAG), although its use has been superseded to a great extent by the CRS.
Travel Trade Yearbook	Contacts for hundreds of companies in different sectors of the travel industry.

Information sources	What sort of information can you find here?
Travel Information Manual (TIM)/ Travel Trade Visa Guide/ Travel Express Visa Guide	Visa and other statutory requirements for overseas countries. TIM can now also be accessed on the CRS.
Passenger air tariff	Airfare information
Trade press	Industry updates, destination and product information, general news. (e.g. Travel Trade, Travel Weekly etc.)
General print and electronic media, travel magazines and even news bulletins for current issues	General destination and product information. News services can supply very current information on the day to day developments such as flood, social unrest, exchange rates and so forth.
Educationals/product familiarisations	Opportunities to experience products and services first hand.
Other organisations in the industry	To get information and advice from an organisation which specialises in a particular product or destination
The internet, travel websites, travel advisor, blogs	A major resource of all types of information destinations, airline, current affairs, hotels, just to name a few. The internet is fast becoming an increasing popular means of booking travel arrangements.
Travel companies product launches, travel shows and information nights	A way to gain knowledge on specific products with specific travel companies, update you on new product information on the market and to keep in touch with people in the travel industry.
Government agencies such as national parks and wildlife services or government tourism offices	General destination and product information

Additional sources of information

Whilst the above sources are most commonly used, other sources that can be accessed include, but are not limited to:

- Intranet Websites
- Internal information databases
- Product manuals
- Supplier information and sales kits and their sales representatives
- Destination and product experts in wholesale reservation call centres
- Confidential and general industry tariffs
- Preferred contracts or agreements
- Official country tourist offices, authorities and bureaus
- Your own travel experience
- Colleagues.



Testimonials

Naturally any testimonial that is collected by a tourism organisation is a valuable asset that can be used to provide an accurate reflection on the performance of the organisation or an individual staff member.

Testimonials are very good marketing and promotional tools as they are statements from actual consumers, not messages given by organisational staff.

A testimonial can be a formal statement testifying to:

- Someone's character, performance, professionalism, qualifications, skills or achievements
- The virtues of a company and the destinations and services it provides
- How the experience benefited them on a personal basis.

Ideally testimonials should include the person's:

- Name
- Title
- Company
- Head-shot photograph.



Quotations

Quotations are used by tourism and travel organisations to sell their destinations and services, through the use of suppliers, summarised in a way that adds value for the customer.

Information commonly included in a quotation includes:

- The Travel Agent detail (Agency letterhead/logo)
- The passenger names
- The destinations or services booked
- Inclusions and exclusions
- The status of the items.
- The gross price – usually quoted per person
- The conditions of booking, amendment and cancellation
- The payment schedule for deposit and final money
- Information relating to other travel documentation including visa requirements, travel insurance, destination information etc.

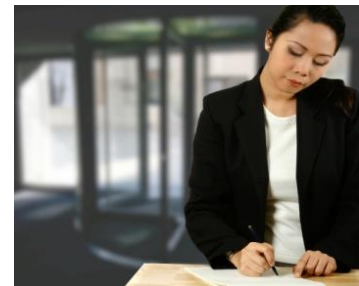


Personal observations

One of the best types of information that can be used by an organisation is that which has been personally collected.

This includes:

- Personal notes
- Report and findings
- Log books
- Records of interviews
- Notes of first-hand meetings.





Identify popular formats of destination information

Activity 2

You are to identify four popular formats that you would use to provide destination information to potential customers. You are to explain why you would use these items.

Formats containing destination information	Reason for using this format

1.2 Describe criteria for capturing destination information

Introduction

Whilst there are endless pieces of destination information available, it is essential that you are focused on collecting information that will be useful in relation to providing relevant and tailored advice and services to your customers.

Importance of having useful and appropriate destination information

It will be up to you to determine exactly what destination knowledge will be useful to meet the needs of your customers.

For all businesses within the tourism industry, it is important to have relevant and up-to-date information so you can:

- To demonstrate the professionalism of the business and your individual level of professionalism and expertise
- To answer routine questions that customers and guests expect you to be able to answer.
- Provide destination information and advice to all types of customers
- Provide specific destination advice to all types of customer
- To provide additional information which will enhance the customer's appreciation of their stay, the destination they have bought or the service they have booked
- To advise customers of up-coming events, specials etc. that the venue plans to offer
- To make recommendations and suggestions when asked for your opinion
- Selling tourism destinations to the customer
- Quote specific individual tourism destination prices
- Booking and coordinating a supplier service for the customer
- Receiving and processing a reservation from a customer
- Processing financial transactions
- Issuing customer travel documentation
- Issuing itineraries
- Participate in destination launches and explain the features of the destinations
- To generate repeat business from customers
- To generate referral business
- To comply with general operational requirements.



Criteria for capturing destination information

In the previous section, the different sources of destination information and items containing destination information have been identified.

Before information is actually sought, it is important to identify criteria for capturing destination information.

The criteria for capturing destination information must include:

- Accuracy
- Currency
- Completeness
- Reliability and reputation of source
- Cost
- Ease-of-access
- Copyright-free status of information.



Methods to ensure compliance with information collection criteria

Methods to ensure you meet the above mentioned criteria for collecting destination include, but are not limited to:

- Use of checklists
- Putting yourself in the eyes of the customer
- Checking to ensure you have all necessary information
- Identify date in which current information was compiled
- Checking version of the brochure or information
- Checking on the website for accurate 'real time' information
- Contacting the supplier to verify information.





Reflect on consequences of 'inaccurate' destination information

Activity 3

You are required to reflect on a personal experience or 'case study' where the provision of inaccurate destination information has negatively impacted on a travel experience.

What was the inaccuracy?	
What was the cause of the inaccuracy?	
How did it impact on the customer?	
How did it impact on the travel supplier?	
How did it impact on the travel agent?	



Read and review destination information

When you capture destination information through the use of various sources it is important to read and review the information and determine its importance, accuracy and relevancy for your organisation and customers

Objectives of reading and reviewing captured destination information

Objectives of reviewing destination information that you have captured include:

- Verifying the accuracy, relevance and sources of the data – as mentioned above
- Confirming the applicability and utility of material researched and provided
- Determining degree of usefulness of the information
- Determining if additional information, material or data is required to meet identified needs
- Ensuring that no obvious sources of information have been overlooked
- Meeting with the information user to check that the material gathered is appropriate for their needs
- Meeting with researchers to clarify points of ambiguity, as appropriate.



Interpreting destination information

The aim of interpreting information is to analyse all the information collected with the hope of providing a summary of key pieces of evidence in which assumptions, conclusions and recommendations be based.

When interpreting information, it is important that the correct information is derived, in its intended format. Attempt to put the information in perspective to the objectives.

There may be vast amounts of information that has been collected. It is your role to identify which pieces of information are valid and purposeful, excluding information that is not relevant in answering the original objectives, or cannot be used to help substantiate or clarify findings.

The process is not to find reason or purpose in all the information collected, but to methodically compile and interpret evidence that is relevant.

Try to use the information to answer the research objectives and to provide supporting evidence to substantiate the findings.

Purpose of interpreting information

This serves a number of purposes including:

- Gaining further understanding of the information
- Identifying any questions you may have
- Identify the key points in which you may convey to stakeholders, colleagues or clients.

This process may include:

- Analysis and interpreting the Information
- Classifying the information
- Preparing summaries with supporting evidence of the results of the data analysis.

1.3 Identify client needs relating to destination information that may be required

3.1 Identify client and colleague needs relating to destination information that is required

Introduction

When sourcing destination information for potential clients, it is important that all relevant needs are considered.

Naturally the information to be collected must meet the needs of the client, but there are other needs that must be addressed.

This section will look at the different needs that will guide and impact the purpose and types of destination information to be collected.

Summary of organisational and customer needs

Whilst the needs of the organisation and customer will be explained in more detail in this section, they can be summarised as including:

- Reference to specific requests or questions that have been made
- Specific data sharing with sales staff and specialist destination colleagues
- Providing detailed information to new employees
- Specific requirements relating to target client groups with which nominated colleagues are engaged.



Review organisational needs

Besides the client, it is essential to consider your business when providing destination information, especially when quoting packages or any information including prices. Where the organisation is to offer tourism products and services, where a profit margin is incorporated, there are specific organisational needs that must be taken into consideration.

These include but not limited to:

- Business objectives
- Key market segments or clients
- Types and style of tourism activities and destinations current offered
- Types of destinations or services that could be combined with current activities and services
- How the information provided could be used to improve service
- Enhancing and expanding destination range including destination initiatives that conform to business plan and marketing objectives



- Movement into new target markets
- Reputation and image
- Business agreements, including franchise and other contractual arrangements
- Meeting competition
- Involvement of colleagues in determining requirements
- Potential increase in business and profitability.



Reviewing these aspects of a tourism business is useful for identifying destination information to be provided. The information provided should be complementary to the existing business and marketing strategy of the organisation and the style of destinations that your organisation is known for promoting.

The information you provide must always meet the expectations of and improve the tourism experience for your clients.



Identify organisational needs

Activity 4

Based on the typical travel or tourism organisation:

- Identify any organisational needs you would need to consider when collecting and providing destination information
- Identify how you can meet these needs.

Types of organisational needs	Methods to meet these needs

Specific sales needs

Ultimately the goal of collecting destination information is to provide the best possible service and to meet the client's needs thus enabling you to make the sale and process the booking.

The first step in collecting information is to identify the needs or reasons why collecting information is essential.

Specific sales needs may relate to:

- Consultation with client – in person, via telephone or email
- Non-negotiable client needs, including budget, timing, duration of travel, required destination and activities, health
- Requests from and preferences of client, including general enquiries and special interest requests, travel preferences, timing and designated destination activities
- Source and provide information and advice
- Make recommendations
- Check availability and prices
- Provide quotation including booking terms and conditions
- Processing a reservation, including booking and coordinating supplier services and destinations
- Collect applicable deposits and provide to applicable parties
- Provide written confirmation and due dates for final payment
- Collect final payment and provide to applicable parties
- Processing financial transactions, including payment of deposits and full-payment for bookings
- Issue or secure non-air and air travel documentation and provide to customer
- Need to amend an existing booking due to unforeseen circumstances
- Cancellations or alterations made to bookings.



One of the keys in gathering key pieces of relevant information is to carefully yet effectively search for information.

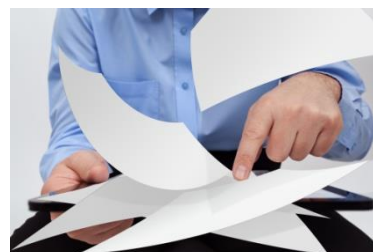
It is important that you have identify a clear topic of your search and to identify objectives of what you are trying to achieve when searching for information, otherwise you can very easily become side-tracked and spend considerable time looking for information that may not be relevant.

Assessing destination information needs

When assessing information needs, do not get overwhelmed with too much information.

Only seek out the information that you need. The following questions can be of assistance when assessing information needs.

- What types of decisions are you regularly called on to make?
- What types of information do you need to make these decisions?
- What types of information do you regularly get?
- What types of information would you like to get that you are not now getting?
- What information would you want daily? Weekly? Monthly? Yearly?
- What specific topics would you like to be kept informed of?
- What types of data analysis programs would you like to be kept informed of?
- What do you think would be the four most helpful improvements that could be made to the present information system?



Identify clients

It is important to understand the different types of clients that may be destination information.

Clients can be anyone, from anywhere.

They can be of any age.

Clients may include:

- Domestic and international people
- Males and females
- People from different age groups
- Special interest groups
- Special needs clients
- Open groups, i.e., groups comprising an unpredictable mix of the general public
- Homogenous target market groups as defined by various demographic characteristics.



Once different types of clients and market segments have been identified, it is essential to understand what their needs may be, when seeking appropriate destination information.

Whilst there will be generic needs that all clients will have, each market segment will also have their own specialised needs that must be addressed.

By understanding the needs of your potential clients, it can help guide your research efforts.

By understanding the range and types of needs that clients have, it helps to identify which destinations and services will be required to satisfy these needs.

Generic client needs

Whilst every tourism client has their own individual needs, there are a number of generic needs that travel staff must address when providing destination information.

These needs include:

- Information matches their requests
- Value for money
- 'Offering' reflecting what was advertised
- Expectations met / exceeded
- To receive friendly service
- To be safe
- To be dealt with in a prompt and courteous manner
- To receive assistance when necessary
- To be in comfortable, clean surroundings.

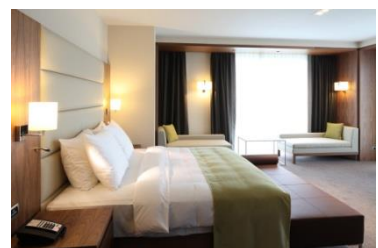


Specific target market needs

Different clients from different target markets will have their own their own specific needs. It is important that staff recognise the needs of each target market and tailor destination information accordingly.

Following are different target target markets and their specific needs:

- Business – computer and internet access, newspapers, executive lounges, laundry services, business or executive centre, business and news channels. Business men are more likely to frequent a hotel bar and eat in the restaurant
- Women – hairdryers, larger mirrors, healthier food options, specific bathroom amenities, fashion magazines, bath. Business women are more likely to use the gym and eat room service
- Family – interconnecting rooms, costs, entertainment options, child care facilities, children's television programs, package deals and safety
- Leisure – cheaper rates, local attractions, concierge services
- Elderly – single beds, medical facilities, suitable food options and cheaper rates
- Groups – need for large allocation of rooms, cheap rates, meeting rooms, specialised menus, bus access and parking.





Identify needs of different market segments

Activity 5

You are required to identify the possible needs of different market segments that may ask for destination information in a travel and tourism organisation.

You are to identify the strategy, destinations or services you feel could meet these needs.



Market segment	Strategy, destination or service to meet need
International clients – General	
Business – General	
Business – Men	
Business – Women	
Leisure – General	

Market segment	Strategy, destination or service to meet need
Leisure - FIT (Free Independent Travellers)	
Leisure - Large Groups	
Leisure - Honeymooners	
Family clients - with children less than 4 years old	
Family clients - with children aged 4-16	
Sporting groups	
Adventure seekers	

Identify types of destination information



As can be seen in Section 1.1, there are sources of destination information. The information provided by each will be valuable and essential in providing information and advice to your customers.

Following are types of destination information that should be gathered as it will be required to provide accurate advice to customers.

General destination information

General destination information may include:

- General destination information
- Statistical information
- Currency
- Maps
- Travel guides
- Events
- Languages
- Safety
- Government information
- Time zones
- Communications.



Local community information

Staff should have a thorough understanding of:

- Zoos, animal and wildlife parks
- Museums
- Natural attractions – parks, reserves, gardens
- Built or 'man-made' attractions
- Prominent and historic buildings
- Amusement parks and theme parks
- Areas, districts and streets
- Sporting and recreational facilities
- Markets
- Resorts
- Casinos
- Currency exchange



- Emergency services
- Churches and places of worship
- Public and private transport options.

The purpose of presenting the above is not to develop a comprehensive list but to give an idea of the diversity of locations/sites about which visitors may require information.

International destination information



When providing information on international destinations to your customers, you will need to advise them of the government regulations that apply when people wish to leave the country.

In addition to passport and visa information, you will need to inform your customers of the health and safety precautions of each particular destination and any customs regulations that apply.

A visa is a stamp or document placed in passports by an authorised representative of a country, permitting passage to a country and allowing the visitor to remain there for a limited amount of time.

Tours

You should be aware of the types of tours on offer in a destination.

Different customers will be interested in different types of tours, so it is important that you have a good selection for them to choose from, for example:

- Multi-day bus tours with a guide
- Walking tours
- Special interest tours
- Cycling tours
- Drive yourself tours
- Low budget tours.



Tour information

- Company name, name of tour and duration
- Departure date, time and location address
- End date, time and location address
- Type of accommodation e.g. single, twin-share
- Tour company specific baggage labels
- Hotel list – names, address and telephone numbers for hotels used on tour
- Tour information booklet
- Included services – arrival and departure transfers.

Attractions



Probably the most important single feature is that a destination must have an attraction.

Attractions can range from a notable historic site, to a scenic location, or a place where some special event is taking place.

Attractions have value in themselves, but they are also evaluated by the traveller from several viewpoints. One aspect of importance is the positive 'distance-pull' of an attraction. In

simple terms, this means that an attraction must have enough appeal to make it worthwhile for the traveller to make the journey.

Each attraction has a different 'distance-pull' and each individual traveller has his or her own set of values that influences how they evaluate the distance-pull of the attractions.

Every country can claim to have some attractions that might be of interest to a customer.

It is important to remember that tourist attractions can be:

- Natural
- Man-made.

Activities

Attractions are the main reason for choosing a specific destination. However, it is necessary at most destinations to provide for some activities to supplement the major attractions.

These activities are established so the tourist will have 'something to do when there is nothing to do!' Activities give the tourist something to do when the weather is inclement and after dark.



Going on a nature walk, attending a minor sporting fixture, playing golf or tennis are examples of activities tourists participate in while at their destination. Activities are there for casual enjoyment.

History

Many people are interested in history, and therefore information on the history of a destination can be important to customers. History adds colour and life to a destination.

Knowing what has happened in the past will give an insight into the destination as it is today.

Geographical features

Geographical features include:

- Mountain ranges
- Lakes
- Rivers
- Caves
- Waterfalls
- Rock formations
- Beaches
- National parks.



Your customers may want information on the geography of a destination because it contributes to the reason why they want to travel to this destination.

Local customs and culture

Every destination will have customs that are specific to that place and that particular culture. These will most likely be of interest to your customers.

Each destination is unique and may have language and customs which are quite different from your own.

Although this may be the major reason for the country's attraction, it is also important that these differences are respected.



Climate

It is important that you understand the weather conditions and patterns of the destination.

Your customer will need to know what the weather is like so that they know what they need to take with them and whether they will cope in these climatic conditions.



Accommodation

As previously mentioned there are a wide range of accommodation options, ranging from five-star hotels to budget accommodation.

Information that needs to be sought in relation to accommodation includes, but is not limited to:

- Room types
- Tariffs
- Destinations and services
- Room facilities
- Location and distance to attractions
- Packages
- Blocked dates
- Seasons and times
- Minimum purchase
- Booking and stay requirements
- Property name and address
- Room type and category
- Number of nights
- Check-in and check-out dates
- Check-in and check-out times
- Day use or late check-out if applicable
- Inclusions e.g. full buffet breakfast, arrival drinks, fruit basket
- Extra charges payable direct e.g. rollaway bed
- Special requests e.g. cot, double bed
- Special promotions e.g. hotel meal credit per room per stay.



Amenities and services

Amenities and services refer to the provision of basic services for travellers including:

- Toilet blocks
- Water
- Electricity
- Food and beverage including restaurants, cafes, bistros
- Medical services
- Banks and post offices
- General safety facilities including fire, police emergency services
- Entertainment
- Sporting
- Shopping.



Airlines

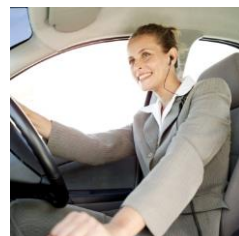
- Airline or combination of airlines
- Airport codes
- Airline codes
- City codes
- Flight numbers
- Schedules / timetables
- Destinations
- Routing
- Origin and destination
- Code share flights
- Normal fares
- Discounted fares, including infants, children, students, pensioners and groups
- Fares for unaccompanied children
- Promotional fares and packages
- Taxes
- General air travel rules and restrictions of the host country, including regional requirements, where applicable
- Class of travel
- Stopovers
- Mileage restrictions allowed



- Minimum and maximum stays
- Ticketing time limit
- Payment conditions.

Car hire

- Company, category, type
- Pick-up and drop-off depots, the depot addresses and opening/closing times
- Pick-up and drop-off dates and times
- Inclusions and exclusions e.g. unlimited kilometres, insurance and taxes
- Special requests e.g. baby seat, ski rack, GPS
- Notes e.g. a valid international driver's license is required.



Cruises

- Name of the ship and voyage number
- Embarkation date, time and port address
- Disembarkation date, time and port address
- Grade/category and cabin type and number
- Passenger dining preference
- Pre-booked special requirements e.g. gluten free diet, wheelchair.



Transfers

- Name of company providing the transfer
- Local address and local telephone contact number of company providing the transfer
- Type of transfer e.g. private car, seat in coach, airport shuttle
- Pick-up date, time and location including address or terminal number
- Drop-off date, location e.g. Park Royal Hotel, Singapore
- Special instructions in relation to transfer.

Rail

- Name of Pass
- Duration and type of pass e.g. 3 Day Adult or 4 Day Flexi
- Validity dates.





Identify destination information for a variety of trips

Activity 6

You are to identify the different pieces of destination information that you would require if you were to plan one of the following trips:

- 4 week trip for a family of five persons (parents aged 50-60 with children aged 17,11 & 5) to Europe. They want to visit at least 3 countries and are interested in seeing key attractions and also age related recreational activities for the children
- 3 week cruise around the Caribbean for an elderly couple
- 1 week budget adventure trip in an ASEAN country for a couple aged 25
- Luxury 1 week trip to an ASEAN country for a couple aged 60
- Business trip for a group of 5 persons to a major ASEAN city. They need to book a conference room for 10 persons for 4 days and then incorporate sightseeing for a day after business has been completed.



For the purpose of this exercise, the clients come from your own home town.

What are key pieces of information you would gather?	What items / format did the information come in?

1.4 Research destination information

Introduction

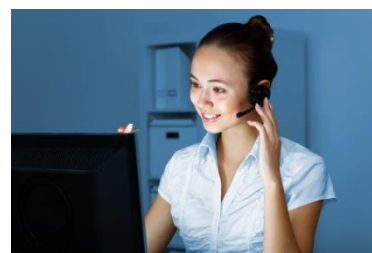
Now that you have identified different types of destination information that may suit the needs of clients, it is now time to start the research process.

The aim of the research process is to collect accurate and relevant destination information to meet the needs of the client and any requests they have made.

Steps in researching destination information

This section will explore the different ways in which destination information may be gathered. It will focus on:

- Identify the research points
- Identify types of formal and informal research techniques
- Recollection of personal observations
- Accessing internal information
- Accessing external sources of information
- Visits sources of information
- Establishing industry networks.



Each of these different channels of information have their own benefits and is vital in building a solid base of information, that whilst can meet the needs of current individual requests, can certainly be used in future enquiries.

Identify the research points

The first step is to try to identify exactly where the focus of research and information collection should be concentrated on.

As seen earlier in this manual, there are a number of ways in which client needs can be identified. Naturally the use of a quotation planner is the most advantageous tool in identifying all the needs clients may have.



By identifying the research points, the process of undertaking research will be able to be performed in a methodical and efficient manner.

Identify types of formal and informal research techniques

There is a number of formal and informal research techniques used to collect destination information, including:

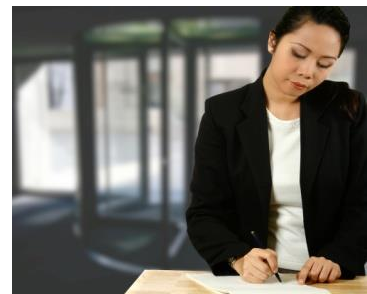
- Informal discussions with colleagues and clients
- Formal study, including study undertaken on-the-job provided by employers or vocational training undertaken in personal time and at personal expense
- Reading literature, including brochures, magazines, media articles, trade journals, guide books and destination material
- Attending relevant information sessions and events, including destination launches, updates, seminars, trade conferences and exhibitions
- Visiting destinations, venues, attractions and sites, including familiarisations
- Direct contact with organisations from the targeted destination
- Accessing the internet and targeted destination websites
- Watching videos, television and films.

Recollection of personal observations and experiences

Naturally one of the best types of information that can be used by a sales person is that which has been personally collected or experienced. The first reference point when collecting information for a client is to recollect personal observations and experiences

This includes:

- Previous bookings
- Discussions had with previous clients
- Familiarisation tours previously conducted
- Personal notes
- Report and findings
- Log books
- Records of interviews
- Notes of first-hand meetings.



Accessing internal information



In the majority of cases, destination information can be obtained through the investigation and extraction of data from internal information systems.

As you can imagine, collecting information from internal sources is certainly more cost and time effective than sourcing from external sources. Therefore it should realistically be the first place to look when seeking information.

Not only will it be 'on hand', it is often tailored to the needs of the operation and can identify more accurately what is happening inside the business more than information obtained externally.

Types of internal information sources

Internal information may be obtained from a number of different sources depending on the scope, nature and technological capabilities of the host enterprise and may include:

- Destination information previously collected
- Customer feedback information
- Automated information systems
- Computerised reservation systems
- Destinations and services inventories.

Utilising colleagues, supervisors and managers

These people are your first-line sources of destination information. You should feel free to ask them questions whenever you need to find information.

Get to know them and actively seek out their opinions, experiences and views.

They can help you find out what is happening, where the business is heading, what they think of the industry and its various stakeholders and what they intend doing personally.

Information may be sought from:

- Head Office
- Other businesses within the chain
- Management
- Colleagues

Quite simply requesting information may include:

- Asking internal colleagues to provide existing information through:
 - Meetings
 - Discussions
 - Emails
 - Training sessions
- Requesting colleagues to manipulate existing data in order to generate new data
- Collecting information from a centralised 'share' drive
- Looking at the company 'intranet' site.

Arrange to receive external information

Naturally there will be a number of suitable ways in which to make contact with organisations, as identified in Section 1.1, when seeking destination information. Given that most organisations may not be in your immediate geographical location, personal face to face contact is not possible.

Methods of contacting businesses include:

- Telephoning targeted organisations
- Making face-to-face requests of staff that visit their office
- Making e-mail requests
- Registering to receive information, newsletters and up-dates.
- Paying to receive material
- Asking organisations to forward information.



Contact sources of destination information

Activity 7

Based on the trip selected in Activity 6, please identify how you would sources of destination information to gather information to help provide a quotation for the client.



Type of organisation	Method of requesting information	Information to be requested	Format of information

Visit sources of information

At times you may be required to visit sources of information

This opportunity to gather a first-hand understanding of the source, including key personnel who will be instrumental in sharing information is very beneficial.

Benefits of visiting sources

It is extremely advantageous to visit sources as they provide a first-hand opportunity to:

- Meet key personnel
- Talking with personnel to obtain, clarify, update and identify supplementary relevant information
- Gain an understanding of the operation
- Viewing operations and making personal observations
- Clarify and explain your request for information
- Receive electronic and hard copy files in a manner that is more user friendly than delivering them through other sources such as emails or courier services
- Reviewing additional information available at the source
- Get any questions answered
- Identify the potential of informational sources that can be utilised at a later date
- Recording interviews and taking photographs or other recorded images.



Visit destination sites as a visitor

Methods to understand different destination sites include, but not limited to:

- Experience it as a visitor
- Queue for rides, shows or other attractions
- Use the facilities as a tourist would
- Buy food and drinks
- Take the tours, view the exhibits and engage with what is available – walk the walks, visit all the attractions, ride all the rides, participate in activities which are promoted to visitors, see the sights, feed the animals, play the games
- Take notes
- Listen to what the staff at the facility say, and watch how they work and respond to and engage with visitors
- Visit the site at different times and on different days
- Get a comprehensive overview and experience as to:
 - What is available at different times
 - How the visitor experience changes with times, days and events



- Observe the visitors – to:
 - Identify what they appear to like or not like so much
 - What they do and what they say – are there things you can learn from this observation of ‘paying customers’ to factor into your provision of visitor information?
- Go to every area of the site – you must gain first-hand experience of all the service, facilities and features.



Identify desired visits

Activity 8

For each of the following points, you are to identify one (1) company you would wish to visit to help you to:

- Access information for your trip in Activity 6
- To gather general information that would help a travel and tourism establishment.



Access information for your trip in Activity 6

Name of company	
Contact Details	
Focus of the visit	
Activities you would like to undertake as part of the visit	
Information you would wish to collect as part of visit	

Establishing industry networks

Developing your own industry network

As a member of the tourism industry, it is vital to build your industry network. This involves reaching out to all people in all aspects of the industry and discussing industry happening, trends and current information. The more people you meet and the more information you accumulate provides you with a sound understanding of the industry and will help your career progression.

Networking with industry colleagues

It is very worthwhile to network with industry colleagues when you get the opportunity to attend destination launches, seminars, educationals and the like.

You are not only constantly learning but you are also mixing with other tourism professionals, many of them having knowledge, experience and skills that you do not have.



Creating an industry network

Activity 9

You are to identify four (4) possible contacts whom you would like to invite to an industry network you would create.

This network can be used for whatever purpose you decide, including seeking assistance and advice or to share ideas.



Desired contact	Contact details	Purpose of inclusion in an industry network

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

1.1 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 1,2

1.2 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 3

1.3 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 4,5,6

1.4 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 7,8,9

1.5 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 11,12,13
-

Summary

Generate initial destination knowledge

Identify sources of destination information

Importance of having updated destination information

- Sources of destination information:
 - Airlines
 - Other travel suppliers
 - Suppliers and providers of support and ancillary services
 - Accommodation
 - Attractions and Theme Parks
 - Tour Operators
 - Inbound Tour Wholesaler
 - Outbound Tour Wholesaler
 - Retail Travel Agents
 - Local, regional and national information services
 - Meetings and Events
 - Ministries of Tourism
 - Tourism Boards
 - Industry Authorities
 - Industry Associations
- Items containing destination information.

Describe criteria for capturing destination information

- Importance of having useful and appropriate destination information
- Criteria for capturing destination information
- Methods to ensure compliance with information collection criteria
- Read and review destination information
- Interpreting destination information.

Identify client needs relating to destination information that may be required

Identify client and colleague needs relating to destination information that is required

- Summary of organisational and customer needs
- **Review organisational needs**
- Specific sales needs
- Assessing destination information needs
- Identify clients
- Generic client needs
- Specific target market needs
- Identify types of destination information
 - General destination information
 - Local community information
 - International destination information

- Tours
- Attractions
- Activities
- History
- Geographical features
- Local customs and culture
- Climate
- Accommodation
- Amenities and services
- Airlines
- Car hire
- Cruises
- Transfers
- Rail.

Research destination information

- Identify the research points
- Identify types of formal and informal research techniques
- Recollection of personal observations and experiences
- Accessing internal information
- Arrange to receive external information
- Visit sources of information
- Establishing industry networks.

Element 2: Update destination knowledge

2.1 Register to receive updated destination information

Introduction

In the previous section we have explored the different sources of destination information and methods to research relevant information.

When sourcing information, whilst direct contact with external providers, as mentioned in the previous section is an invaluable way to get information regarding specific destinations and services, quite often you may need to gather more generic destination information relating to the industry as a whole, new laws, regulations, businesses or trends.

This information will commonly be obtained through various publications, produced by leading government or industry leaders and authorities.

In order to access this information you will need to register to receive it.

Methods to register for information

Registering for industry information may include:

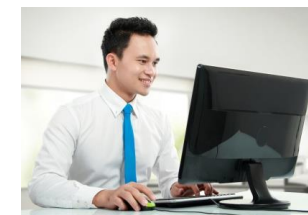
- Registering on-line
- Paying a fee
- Establishing required password and username, if required
- Lodging host enterprise details with destination information source
- Establishing the bona fides of the host enterprise
- Joining an association or body in order to enable access.





Identify publications to register

Activity 10



If you were a travel agent / tourism operator in your country, what are examples of publications, either in hard copy or online, that you would register to access valuable industry and destination information that would suit your organisation.

Name of publication	Format of publication	Reasons for registering to publication	Key features	Cost

1.5 Research destination information

2.2 Integrate updated information into existing destination information

2.3 Initiate new files for new information and/or new destinations

Introduction

Every tourism organisation will have its own method of filing and storing destination information. It is important to know where to look for certain pieces of information.

Your office will have a system of filing all information so that it is easy to retrieve. Check and make sure that you understand how the information is organised so that you can source it readily.

It is imperative that all information stored is totally up to date at all times. You must provide customers with current information. There should be a system to regularly cull and replace old brochures, review computer databases and other forms of information.

It is important that any system that is used:

- Contains an index to assist in identifying required information
- Is in compliance with internal guidelines and authorities regarding the entering of data onto systems.



Enterprise requirements and procedures

Once the relevant industry and destination information has been sourced, it must be stored for future use as deemed most appropriate by the enterprise, in keeping with any relevant policies and procedures.

Enterprise requirements and procedures will address:

- The type, style and nature of the storage and retrieval system to be used
- The type, style, nature, size and location of the information display or file
- Identification of personnel with responsibility for:
 - Capturing initial information, brochures, price lists, maps, flyers and promotional material from local and other attractions and venues
 - Updating the information brochures to ensure it remains current providing up to date materials, prices, opening times and explanations of shows, events or displays
 - Entering new or revised information into an electronic system
 - Maintaining the display to keep it looking neat and tidy and to remove soiled, torn materials

- Maintaining the store of materials to ensure the display never runs out of brochures and materials
- Identification of who is authorised to attend meetings to capture destination information.

Categorising destination information collected

You will have a large range of destination information which should be logically filed for easy access and quick service for your customer. These may be divided between:

- Industry, establishment and destination brochures – including those produced by private companies and public tourist agencies and authorities
- Sales and supplier information kits provided by destination providers – including accommodation outlets, providers and support businesses, shopping centres and precincts, attractions and event organisers
- Destination manuals
- Advertising fliers.

These may further be broken down based on:

- General information on different locations, destinations and regions
- Geographic location of destinations and services at the destinations.
- Styles of destination and services available within destinations
- Seasonal availability of destination, including low and high seasons, and weather-related seasonal influences
- Destination types, for example cruises, tours, accommodation etc.
- General tour information
- Information relating to touring routes and locations
- Information relating to target market groups
- General accommodation information
- General transport information.



Options for storing destination information

Destination information inventory systems may be:

- Manual filing systems
- Computerised systems
- Combination of the above.

Regardless of the system used, it is important to remember that the focus of capturing and storing destination information is to use it as part of the service delivery that the organisation provides to clients to help facilitate their travel needs.



Manual filing systems

Card reference systems

Many individuals like to keep a file of useful contacts, usually alphabetised business cards.

These contacts are people in the industry who can provide detailed and specific information that may not be available via other methods.

Files

These may include information that can be given to customers or may just be a reference for staff. They usually contain master copies of all brochures that are available within your workplace. Sometimes notes may be added that are a useful reference for staff.

Brochures may also be kept that are not on display for customers. Agencies usually have 'preferred destinations' that they try to promote and sell. Sometimes it is helpful to have other references and options in case the customer specifically requests a destination not offered by your preferred supplier.

These files may also include information such as maps, sales kits and destination manuals.

Creating a Resource File

Imagine that you are a travel agent working in an agency which sells a lot of holidays.

You may need to keep records of general information about various destinations as well as tourism specific information.

This will vary depending on your workplace. The challenge with storing information is to know what is worth keeping and how to file it. Some of the problems associated with creating a resource file include:

- Not easily accessible
- Out of date material not removed
- More than one source of the same information
- Information too detailed or irrelevant.



Public area displays

Some form of manual filing system coupled with a public area display featuring racks and displays of brochures etc. from various tourism businesses will usually suffice and is cost effective and operationally effective.

The glossy brochures can be kept in the public display whilst more detailed and less frequently requested information can be kept in the file.

You may have destination brochures displayed in the office for the public to access including a range of cruises and packaged tours, usually divided between domestic and international. In most tourism organisations there will be a range of individual local tour and accommodation operator brochures and general information brochures on the region and other regions.

Back of house storage areas

In the back room of the office there will be storage space for other destination brochures which you may use if your preferred destination is not available or does not offer what the customer wants.

A large range of timetables, insurance policies and other general tourism destination information must also be on hand and it is imperative that you are aware of where this information is held.

Filing cabinets

Whilst the nature of the filing system to be used to store the information will be an individual choice, the use of cabinet drawers is a great option.

If you decide to use this option, make sure that whoever is to use this information can access these drawers readily and knows where things are in the file. There's little point in the information being locked up where staff are unable to get to it or in having the information but being unable to locate where it is.



Personal information manual

You may choose or be required to compile your own personal information manual. You may have extracted a newspaper article or taken notes from a sales representative or local tour operator about information pertinent to your organization. These also have to be filed logically and it is important to date all information to establish whether it is current and filed under the correct section.

Contact details of tourism businesses

If you are unable to obtain the information your customer requires from the sources within the office or simply need guidance on where to start, that's when you refer to appropriate websites or phone the appropriate wholesaler or principal's reservation or sales department directly for assistance. You will soon gain an understanding of which wholesalers or principals represent or package which part of the globe and what area they specialise in.





Identify categories for destination information

Activity 11

You are to identify 6 – 10 possible categories of destination information you would set up for a travel and tourism organisation in your country.





Identify strategy for maintaining manual destination information inventory systems

Activity 12

You are required to identify four strategies for maintaining manual destination information inventory systems.

- 1. _____

- 2. _____

- 3. _____

- 4. _____



Computerised systems

The travel marketplace is a global arena where millions of buyers and sellers work together to exchange travel services.

Among the “shelves” on which buyers search for travel services are world’s global distribution systems.



These systems have become electronic supermarkets linking buyers to sellers and allowing reservations to be made quickly and easily.

Nowadays, more travel is sold over the Internet than any other consumer destination.

A Global Distribution System (GDS) is a network operated by a company that enables automated transactions between third parties and booking agents in order to provide travel-related services to the end consumers. A GDS can link services, rates and bookings consolidating destinations and services across all three travel sectors: i.e., airline reservations, hotel reservations, car rentals, and activities.

The major GDS systems include:

- Travelport (Galileo, & Apollo)
- Travelport (Worldspan)
- Amadeus
- Sabre.



Research a GDS system

Activity 13

You are required to research one of the above mentioned GDS systems and explain:

Purpose of this GDS	
Destinations and service provided	
Benefits for travel agents	
Benefits for tourism suppliers	
Benefits for customers	

Integrating and initiate destination information

Whilst there may be vast amounts of destination information that may be of benefit, it is time to identify:

- Which pieces of information do not need to be communicated or not relevant
- Which pieces of information are essential
- Key points that need to be communicated
- The order of priority for communicating information
- How to structure the information in a way that addresses original objectives or will be understood by the persons whom will need this information.



It is vital that the information that is needed by stakeholders, colleagues or clients is 'tailored' to their needs.

Tasks associated with integrating information into existing destination information include:

- Deleting dated information
- Deleting information files and folders no longer required
- Implementing version control procedures
- Up-dating relevant control index to reflect revised information files and folders
- Adding data to identify date of last update
- Up-dating relevant control index to reflect new information files and folders
- Informing colleagues of the presence of new information.

Identify destination information

Once you have integrated relevant destination, it is important to 'identify' and 'mark' the information so that it can be easily found for future use.

Methods to identify relevant information include:

- Book marking websites
- Recording sources in a project-specific index.
- Copy and pasting key points into separate files
- Highlighting key information
- Filing documents in a logical order.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

2.1 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 10

2.2 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 11,12,13

2.3 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 11,12,13
-

Summary

Update destination knowledge

Register to receive updated destination information

- Methods to register for information.

Capture and record and classify destination and general product information

Integrate updated information into existing destination information

Initiate new files for new information and/or new destinations

- Enterprise requirements and procedures
- Categorising destination information collected
- Options for storing destination information
- Manual filing systems
- Computerised systems
- Integrating and initiate destination information
- Identify destination information.

Element 3:

Communicate destination knowledge

3.2 Share destination information

Introduction

Given that your role is to collect and share destination information, it is essential that any information that you have collected, as previously discussed, is shared with the people who may require that information.

This includes sharing updated destination information with:

- Colleagues
- Potential customers.

This section will explore the importance and methods to share destination information with these two important stakeholders.



Share updated information with colleagues

The basic ways to share new or revised destination information with fellow employees are to:

- Verbally tell your colleagues about what you have learned:
 - On a one to one basis
 - At staff briefings
 - At staff meetings
- E-mail co-workers with the information you have discovered attaching relevant information as applicable
- Update the internal systems such as CRS
- Replace and replenish internal displays information points with new or revised materials
- Arrange for a guest speaker from the venue or attraction to come and talk to staff - explaining the venue or attractions, providing sample items, bringing promotional materials
- Arrange for staff to visit the venue personally so they can gain first-hand experience of the venue.



Share updated information with potential customers

When presenting information to clients, the level of preparation may vary from simply passing over a brochure, providing some verbal information through to preparing a detailed quotation.

Presentation considerations



One of the first steps in this process is to identify the best method in which to get the information to the customer.

Given that a travel company now can reach customers in all corners of the globe, through electronic communication and social media, in many cases the traditional method of face to face meetings may not be possible.

Whilst face to face contact is still the most preferred method, there are many submission methods that can be used to suit the needs of both the customer and travel agent.

There are a number of considerations that must be taken into account when selecting the most appropriate submission method.

Some considerations include:

- Location of the customer – naturally if the customer is not located in your area, the concept of face to face discussion is not possible
- Number of persons to receive quotation – when preparing information for business purposes or for a number of travellers, the information may need to be sent to many persons in different locations
- Reliability of submission methods – depending on the region, some submission methods, such as mail, may be unreliable and quite simply take too long to get to the customer
- Types of documentation required – if the quotation also contains reference materials such as brochures from destination and service providers, mailing of documents may be the most preferred method
- Time frames required – in the event of immediate travel, electronic communication will be the most desirable submission method as it is instantaneous
- Costs – naturally there is great cost associated in mailing proposals on a regular basis. Depending on the organisational requirements, initial quotations may be sent electronically, as it is the most cost effective method of submission.



Destination information submission methods

Destination information can be provided to customers in one of the following ways:

- Verbal explanation
- Provide hard copy materials
- Provide electronic materials.

Verbal explanation

Whilst you as the travel agent may have spent considerable time researching and developing a quotation for a customer, it is important to remember that the customer may have only seen an initial quotation.

Also it is important to remember that customers do not have the same degree and depth of knowledge in the travel industry and the processes involved in making bookings, and that they will need explanation from yourself to help their understanding.

Benefits of providing a verbal explanation

- Explain in more detail the key pieces of information in them
- Answer any questions customers may have
- Provide suggestions and recommendations
- Outline the processes associated with confirming and organising travel arrangements
- Guide them through the sales process.



Providing hard copy materials

Another effective method of providing destination information is through the distribution of hard copy materials. This method may be used as an individual activity or in conjunction with other information delivery methods.

Benefits of providing hard copy materials

There are a number of benefits of distributing hard copy destination information to potential audiences including:

- Utilises an additional learning method – as opposed to listening to a presentation
- Provides comprehensive information
- Provides appealing images
- Provides information in its intended message
- Enables the audience to review information at their own time and at their own pace
- Enables information to be reviewed on multiple purposes
- Enables the audience to show other people information as well
- Enables audience to become familiar with content before subsequent verbal presentations and meetings.



Types of hard copy materials

There are endless hard copy materials that can be provided including:

- Reports
- Brochures
- Quotations
- Invitations
- Travel itineraries
- Handouts
- Fact sheets
- Notes
- Photocopies from policy manuals
- Texts
- Media articles
- Photographs
- Posters
- Flyers
- Marketing materials
- Financial statements.



Providing electronic materials

Sending electronic materials is the most common way of sending information to various stakeholders and customers.

Benefits of distributing electronic materials

There are a number of benefits of distributing electronic destination information to potential audiences including:

- Information can be shared instantaneously
- It guarantees the intended audience receives the information, unlike mail which may go missing
- It enables the sender to see who has received and read the information
- Information can be sent to numerous people
- Information can be sent securely enabling information to remain confidential
- It can be distributed to people around the world, regardless of location
- It is a cost effective method of distributing information
- It reduces storage space required for hard copy documents
- It can be stored in shared 'cloud' systems for access by many people
- Information stored in electronic systems can be updated easily.





Activity 14

Identify advantages and disadvantages of destination information submission methods

For each destination information submission method you are identify two advantages and disadvantages of this method.

Submission method	Advantages	Disadvantages
Verbal explanation		
Provide hard copy materials		
Provide electronic materials		



3.3 Advise clients in relation to information about specific destinations

Introduction

It is a fundamental requirement that staff provide accurate destination information, which not only will meet the needs of clients but hopefully will lead to increased sales.

This section will look at the different considerations that must be addressed when providing clients with information relating to different destinations and other travel arrangements as required.

Customer service basics when presenting destination information

When presenting destination information customer service essentials include the need to:

- Have comprehensive destination knowledge
- Remember to consider customer needs, wants and preferences and suggest only those destinations and services that meet these identified criteria
- Ask questions – to gather information from the customer to identify if the quotation meets their needs, wants and preferences and to clarify related issues
- Be proactive – that is, you need to be able to initiate interaction with customers rather than wait for them to come to you and ask a question or make a purchase
- Provide information, recommendations, advice and suggestions that aligns with identified customer need
- Sell the benefits of destinations and services – as opposed to simply stating the features of the destinations and services
- Overcome objections by customers to making a purchase – by identifying the root cause for the objection and then applying acceptable problem-solving techniques
- Allow customers time and opportunity to consider their purchase – as opposed to rushing them, pressuring them or intimidating them into buying
- Make legitimate all add-on/complementary sales – to optimise the value of the sale and providing what the customer wants without pressuring the customer
- Close the sale – as opposed to allowing the customer to continually ‘think about it’ and eventually decide not to purchase.



It is important to remind yourself of them as the role of providing quotations in person is just more than passing over a piece of paper.

Process of explaining destination information

When communicating destination information it is vital that the client understands what is being introduced and explained to them.

The process of explaining and expanding on quotation information has some vital elements that must be covered, including:

These concept aspects can therefore include:

- Details about physical destinations – where they are made, their characteristics, their price and availability, how to buy those destinations
- Information about the services that are available – including who provides the service, when it is available, how much it costs, what it involves, what it is like and how to book it
- Information on prices, specials, deals and packages – being able to explain how these benefit the customer, what savings they involve, when they are available, when the offer finishes, who is eligible for them and how to obtain them
- Providing personal interpretation and explanation of the quotation
- Providing supplementary information as required
- Explaining the reasons for charges and fees included in the quotation
- Assisting the client to understand the reputation and expertise of nominated suppliers, providers and carriers
- Providing supporting brochures and marketing materials to assist with understanding of the quotation.



Types of destination information to communicate

General information

- Date of quotation and reference number (if applicable)
- Clients name
- Phone contacts
- Email address
- Address
- Dates of travel
- Length of travel and class of travel.

Travel destinations and services

Flights

- Airline details
- Destinations and routings
- Class of travel
- Departure and return dates – remember to include the year
- Fare validity – for sale and for travel dates
- Air fare per person
- Taxes per person (always state that these are subject to change).



Accommodation

- Name of accommodation and location
- Room type and bedding configurations
- Check-in and check-out dates
- Total number of nights
- Any extras or inclusions such as meals, transfers etc.
- Cost per person per night and total amount for the stay.



Cruises

- Name of the cruise line or company
- Name of the ship
- Name of cruise, including code
- Number of days or nights
- Departure and return date, time and location
- Cabin type and deck location.



Tours

- Tour company name
- Tour name, code and duration
- Departure date, time and location/city
- Arrival date, time and location/city
- Rooming details – single, twin, triple
- Inclusions.

Other travel destinations and services

- Company used
- Destinations and services
- Inclusions / exclusions
- Costs.

Transfers

- Date, time and location of transfers
- Type of transfer – seat in coach, private transfers, limousine etc.

Car hire/Rentals

- Name of company they are using – Avis, Budget, Hertz etc.
- Vehicle group or type – compact, midsize, group C etc.
- Transmission – manual or automatic
- Pick up and drop off dates, times and location
- Rate – if paying direct
- Rental Inclusions – mileage, additional drivers, insurances, taxes
- Any additional local payments for additional services e.g. GPS.

Destination information

- Attractions
- Activities
- History
- Language
- Population
- Geographical features
- Local customs and culture
- Climate.

Destination information was discussed in more detail in Section 1.1 of this manual and therefore won't be repeated in this section.



Specialist destination information

Seasonality

Several destinations and services, in particular airfares and accommodation establishments, may be subject to price variances based on seasonality. Simply, this means that the date of the destination or service utilisation determines the price. Examples are:

- Airfares – the date of departure often dictates the fare to be charged
- Hotels – surcharges may apply for weekends
- School holiday periods – demand is high and therefore higher rates usually apply.

Normally the calendar year is divided into various date ranges and labelled and priced accordingly. Some examples:

- High season – most expensive
- Shoulder season – in between
- Low season – least expensive

Seasonality is not limited to these three categories.

Availability & confirmation

All quotes should be provided subject to availability. Never assume that destination products or service will be available.

Make sure that the customer understands that notification to you that they wish to accept the quotation and proceed with a booking, does not constitute a confirmed booking. The booking is only confirmed once you have made contact with the service provider and you have received confirmation in writing. Only then are you in a position to provide a verbal, or preferably, a written confirmation to your passenger.

The confirmation should, minimally, detail:

- What has been booked and confirmed
- Who it has been booked for (the full name)
- The terms and conditions
- Deposit and payment amounts (dates due)
- Acceptable forms of payment
- Credit card merchant fees.



Costing considerations

There are a number of factors influencing variations in costs of travel destination products and services, including:

- Seasonality – high, shoulder, low or peak, off peak or combinations
- Validity dates – what prices apply to what dates
- Date of booking
- Date of travel
- Surcharges – weekend stays, extra bedding
- Restrictions – age, student, senior, nationality, validity of driver licence
- Standard – Luxury, moderate, standard, basic, budget, backpackers
- Inclusions/exclusions – meals, sightseeing, entrance fees, tour escort
- Bedding – single, twin share, triple, quad, multi, dormitory
- Child and infant costs – when is a child a child and when is an infant an infant
- Currency used and conversion rates
- Payments – early bird payments, instant purchase tickets
- Conditions of sale – book by for travel by
- Packages versus single items sold
- Stay Pay – stay 4 nights and pay for 3 nights
- Last minute deals and spot specials – used to fill remaining seats, rooms or cabins.



Additional travel costs

Apart from the detail of the actual destination products and services and the applicable prices, there are other costs that must also be explained to customers including:

- Mandatory organisation service, transaction or planning fee etc.
- Insurance – see below
- Visa – are they required and how much will they cost?
- Airport taxes
- Merchant fees – most credit cards incur these fees which are between 1 – 4%
- Any taxes and levies which are payable direct and which are not included in the quotation
- Extra charges such as hire of GPS, baby seat, child booster, snow chains, roof rack, rollway bed, baby cot charge etc.
- Exchange rate fluctuation – if applicable.



Destination price increases

Regardless of the price of the destination at the time of purchase, there is always a risk that due to particular circumstances that the price may increase even after the booking has been deposited or rarely, after it has been fully paid.

The most common reason for this is the devaluing of local currency against other foreign currencies. The best protection against these types of increases is to pay in full. Most wholesalers/suppliers will NOT increase the price of a particular destination if they have received full and final payment for the applicable arrangements.

Often where an increase is about to be applied, passengers who have booked and paid a deposit, will be given a time limit by which they need to pay in full to avoid the increase. This however may not always be the case.

Increases to airline bookings do not apply once the air ticket has been issued and provided that once issued, there are no changes. However until that time, airline bookings are particularly vulnerable to price increases due to:

- Expiration of the airfare
- Interpretation of airfare rules by the consultant
- Missed ticket deadline
- Change in taxes and levies
- Fuel surcharges.

It is important therefore that passengers are made aware that:

- Taxes and levies can and do vary and are only firm once the ticket is issued
- Until the air ticket is issued, the price may change
- Changes to the bookings may change the price
- Cancellations and amendments, after ticket, issue will incur fees.



Fluctuations in exchange rates



There are some destinations that, while quoted in local currency or United States Dollars (USD) to the Travel Agent and subsequently to the customer, are in fact bought and sold in a foreign currency. This necessitates the conversion of the foreign currency amounts into local currency. The rate used for the conversion can and does vary as the value of the local currency will vary against other currencies on a daily basis.

Where you have received and are providing such a quote to customers, it is vital that this is explained in full.

Further, notice of currency variations resulting in a higher or sometimes lower price must be given in writing. An example of what you may see on a quote from a supplier or operator:

Due to the current economic climate, all prices quoted are subject to currency fluctuations until paid IN FULL.

Prices quoted more than 7 days prior to final payment will be re-assessed at the rate of exchange on the day of payment. This will mean that an increase or a reduction in price may occur at the time of final payment. Once final payment is received the holiday price will no longer be subject to currency fluctuations in either direction.

Booking conditions

Common booking conditions include:

- How to book – who to contact
- Amount of deposit required
- Prices and validity
- Assumption of risk
- Exclusion of liability
- Payment deadline
- Ticketing deadline
- Extension ticketing deadline
- Cancellation by the supplier
- Force Majeure
- Cancellation by the travel agent
- Cancellation charges
- Availability of any type of change to booking
- Availability of changes to class of booking
- Types of booking amendments
- Amendment fees
- Complaints
- Authority of suppliers and tour leaders
- Baggage allowance
- Excess baggage charges
- Health, fitness and age limits
- Publicity
- Privacy
- Governing law.



Deposit, payment and cancellation terms and conditions

General terms and conditions

Whilst there may be an endless set of terms and conditions that may be established, to suit the needs of the respective suppliers and providers, taking into account organisational requirements and the nature of their services, there are common terms and conditions that relate to most travel related quotations.

General terms and conditions include:

- Terms and methods of payment, including dates for payment of deposits and final payment
- Notifications regarding final confirmation of the booking and, where relevant, numbers
- Cancellations and penalties and charges that apply
- Procedures and charges that apply to name and date changes for the booking
- Guarantees and warranties that apply to the destinations and services covered by the quotation
- Age limits
- Health and fitness requirements
- Exclusion and limitation of liability clauses
- Identification of the period for which the quotation is valid
- Whether or not the quotation is subject to change with or without notice
- Reference to associated terms and conditions as imposed by third party providers
- General industry rules, regulations and codes.



Travel Agent Terms and Conditions

Each destination or service included in the quotation will have a set of general conditions which will be provided to you by the wholesaler or operator that you are utilising.

They will commonly include terms and conditions relating to:

- Deposit and how to book
- Payment Options
- Amendments
- Final Payment
- Cancellations and refunds.



Destination or service provider terms and conditions

Individual destination or service providers will often have a set of terms and conditions relating to their particular destination or service.

These will cover, among other items:

- Pricing policy
- Payment conditions
- Inclusions
- Exclusions
- Any restrictions or limitations.



As can be seen in this section there are many terms and conditions provided by various organisations involved in the travel booking process.

Naturally the extent and finer details of terms and conditions may seem overwhelming or not anticipated by the end user. Therefore the role of travel agents in ensuring customers understand them is a vital aspect of providing quotations.

Travel insurance

Travel insurance should always be recommended to passengers to protect against a range of situations, most commonly:

- Cancellation fees
- Medical or dental expenses
- Personal liability
- Accidental death, disability or loss of income
- Emergency travel arrangements e.g. repatriation
- Loss or damage to personal items – luggage, camera, travel documents.



The premium charged will depend on the type of policy required and this depends on many factors, some of which follow:

- Destination and duration
- Purpose of the trip
- Level of cover required
- Age of the passenger
- Excess selected
- Existing medical conditions.

Travel to some countries e.g. United States of America will attract higher premiums due to the high level of cover required for medical expenses.

Similarly, passengers over a certain age or who require cover for existing medical conditions will be subject to a surcharge. Application for this type of cover requires the completion and submission of forms to the insurance company for evaluation.

Limitations

Particular destinations may have stated or self-evident limitations. Awareness in relation to these particular destinations, your client's needs and potential limitations is always a consideration when making recommendations.

Typically these relate to age, fitness or disability. Some examples:

- Contiki Tours - only passengers aged 18-35 years old
- Evergreen Tours - primarily mature aged and seniors
- Peregrine's trekking in the Himalayas - stated fitness levels
- Car hire - age and license requirements
- Flights - mobility/companion requirements
- Unaccompanied minors - children travelling alone
- Accommodation - age of children permitted in room without an adult
- Scuba diving - certification requirements.



Safety and risk – adventure destinations

A number of destinations and services in the market place have some kind of inherent risk. The most common of these are adventure and soft adventure tours or tours to remote destinations.

Most of these Tour Operators will cover this issue in their booking conditions under an 'assumption of risk' type clause. It is important therefore that you routinely provide all passengers with a copy of the terms and conditions and that they confirm that they have read and understood them.



Non operation of the destination – tour cancellation



Whenever you book a scheduled departure of a tour there is always the risk that if the minimum numbers for that particular tour departure is not achieved, that the tour operator may elect to cancel the tour.

Usually, the operator will give sufficient notice of the cancellation and offer alternatives. Never the less, this can cause significant inconvenience, some stress and extra work for the travel consultant if the itinerary has to be reworked.

In addition, cancellation or amendment fees may be incurred for other destinations and services which as a consequence need to be changed, amended or even cancelled.



Identify and share destination information

Activity 15

Based on the trip you have selected in Activity 6, you are required to prepare collect and present destination information that you would present to a client.

You will have 10 minutes to make the presentation.

Please delete sections that do not apply to your client needs.

Client requirements / needs:

Summary description of trip:

Key aspects / inclusions of trip:



QUOTATION COMPONENT	INFORMATION / DETAILS
GENERAL INFORMATION	
Date of quotation and reference number (if applicable)	
Clients name	
Phone contacts	
Email address	
Address	
Dates of travel	
Length of travel and class of travel	
TRAVEL DESTINATIONS AND SERVICES	
Flights	
Airline details	
Destinations and routings	
Class of travel	
Departure and return dates – remember to include the year	
Fare validity – for sale and for travel dates	
Air fare per person	
Taxes per person (always state that these are subject to change)	

QUOTATION COMPONENT	INFORMATION / DETAILS
Accommodation	
Name of accommodation and location	
Room type and bedding configurations	
Check-in and check-out dates	
Total number of nights	
Any extras or inclusions such as meals, transfers etc.	
Cost per person per night and total amount for the stay	
Cruises	
Name of the cruise line or company	
Name of the ship	
Name of cruise, including code	
Number of days or nights	
Departure date, time and location	
Return date, arrival time and location	
Cabin type and deck location	

QUOTATION COMPONENT	INFORMATION / DETAILS
Tours	
Tour company name	
Tour name, code and duration	
Departure date, time and location/city	
Arrival date, time and location/city	
Rooming details – single, twin, triple	
Inclusions	
Other travel destinations and services	
Company used	
Destinations and services	
Inclusions / exclusions	
Costs	
Transfers	
Date	
Type of transfer – seat in coach	

QUOTATION COMPONENT	INFORMATION / DETAILS
Car hire / Rentals	
Name of company they are using – Avis, Budget, Hertz etc.	
Vehicle group or type – compact, midsize, group C etc.	
Transmission – manual or automatic	
Pick up and drop off dates, times and location	
Rate – if paying direct	
Rental Inclusions – mileage, additional drivers, insurances, taxes	
Any additional local payments for additional services e.g. GPS	
DESTINATION INFORMATION	
Attractions	
Activities	
History	
Language	

DESTINATION INFORMATION

Population

Geographical features

Local customs and culture

Climate

SPECIFIC DETAILS

Seasonality

Availability

Costing considerations

QUOTATION COMPONENT	INFORMATION / DETAILS
Additional travel costs	
Destination price increases	
Fluctuations in exchange rates	
Terms and conditions	

QUOTATION COMPONENT	INFORMATION / DETAILS
Scheduling information	

QUOTATION COMPONENT	INFORMATION / DETAILS
Destination codes	
Booking procedures	
Points of departure and arrival	
Touring inclusions and exclusions	

QUOTATION COMPONENT	INFORMATION / DETAILS
Technical specifications for audio-visual and other meetings and events equipment	
Travel insurance	
Visa / permits	
Health permits	
Limitations	
Safety and risk – adventure destinations	
Non operation of the destination – tour cancellation	



Identify and share tourism destination information

Activity 16

You are to identify a tourism destination of your choice, outside of your country.

You are required to conduct research and make a 5 minute presentation to the class providing a summary of the destination and how it would appeal to tourists.

The content of your research and presentation is your choice however may be based on:

- Attractions
- Activities
- History
- Language
- Population
- Geographical features
- Local customs and culture
- Climate.



3.4 Present hard copy information to clients

Introduction

There are a number of types of travel documentation that will be used, either by the organisation or given to customers, as part of providing destination information.

Travel documentation will relate to:

- Non-air documentation
- Air documentation.

Non-air documentation

Non-air documentation may include:

- Accommodation vouchers
- Bus/coach or other forms of transportation tickets
- Car hire/motor home vouchers
- Cruise vouchers
- Tour vouchers
- Vouchers for attractions/theme park entry
- Vouchers for any tourism destination or service
- Meeting or event confirmation letters
- Delegate information packs
- Travel insurance documentation
- Confirmation vouchers
- Visa forms
- Visas
- Passport forms
- Travellers cheque requests
- Passenger itineraries
- Operational itineraries for crews including tourist guides, drivers and tour managers
- Briefing notes for crews
- Passenger lists
- Rooming lists
- Pro-formas
- Sales returns.



Air documentation

Air documentation may include:

- Tickets
- Miscellaneous charge orders
- Credit card charge forms
- Exchange tickets
- Reservation alterations and re-validation stickers
- Pre-paid ticket advices.



Identify travel documents

Activity 17



Based on the trip selected in Activity 6, identify the types of travel documentation you would need to prepare or present to the client.

NON AIR DOCUMENTATION

Type of documentation	Key points to communicate with clients

AIR DOCUMENTATION

Type of documentation	Key points to communicate with clients

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

3.1 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 4,5,6

3.2 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 14

3.3 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 15,16

3.4 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 17
-

Summary

Communicate destination knowledge

Share destination information

- Share updated information with colleagues
- Share updated information with potential customers
- Presentation considerations
- Destination information submission methods:
 - Verbal explanation
 - Providing hard copy materials
 - Providing electronic materials.

Advise clients in relation to information about specific destinations

- Customer service basics when presenting destination information
- Process of explaining destination information
- Types of destination information to communicate:
 - General information
 - Travel destinations and services
 - Specialist destination information.

Present hard copy information to clients

- Non-air documentation
- Air documentation.

Element 4:

Review provision of destination knowledge

4.1 Evaluate sources of destination information

Introduction



In any travel and tourism business it is vital to confirm that the sources of information are reliable and that the actual destination information from each of these sources is accurate and up to date.

Not only is it important that the information itself is accurate, but the end products and services provided are reputable organisations. You do not want to be promoting organisations that are sub-standard.

This section will explore the different ways in which to monitor and evaluate both the sources and the information provided by different sources.

Given that some of these points may have been covered in Section 1.4 of this manual, to avoid duplication, some topics may not be covered in this section.

Importance of evaluating sources of information

It is vital to ensure all materials in the organisation:

- Promote legitimate destinations, suppliers, products and services
- Ensure the information provided is a true reflection of what is being promoted
- Ensure customers are not given, or do not take, materials which relate to offers or products which are no longer available
- Make sure only information is publicly available which shows the current prices
- Help you refer only to current information – in terms of:
 - Offers, deals and packages
 - Prices
 - Schedules
 - Destinations
 - Travel advice
- Continue demonstrating your level of professionalism and attention to detail – if you cannot keep your information sources up-to-date this impacts poorly on the thinking of potential customers.



Strategies for evaluating sources of information

Seeking feedback from colleagues



Countless opportunities for evaluating sources and accuracy of destination information present themselves when talking to colleagues.

Given that they deal with similar or different customers, destinations, suppliers or end products or services, the information that can be gathered can help ensure that you are not only promoting the right businesses, but can also ensure that information provided is accurate and from a variety of trusted sources.

This gives you an excellent chance to get a second impression about what a destination has to offer. We can often see things through parochial eyes that tend to see benefits and advantages that others don't see. Seeing things through someone else's eyes can provide a valuable reality check.

In addition colleagues may belong to a certain club, association or body and can bring to work current information that may include changes to practices, alterations to services and amendments to hours or other aspects.

Other colleagues will be able to provide insight into:

- Their dealings with sources of information
- Their views of end products and sources
- Additional information about a destination which you may be unaware
- Their personal experiences
- Feedback they have obtained from their customers.

Seeking feedback from clients on their return from destinations

Naturally the best way to understand how destination promotional materials compare with the actually experience provided is through feedback sought by clients who have actually visited the destination.

This is the best evaluation method that can be used by a travel company.

In addition, their feedback can be a great promotional tool, given their experience was a positive one, to future clients.

It is essential that:

- Customer feedback is actively sought and encouraged – never simply rely on feedback that 'arrives'. It will be insufficient and possibly biased
- Customer feedback is incorporated into the future direction of the business.



Feedback from customers can be obtained in several ways but in relation to capturing information from customers about their experience with us, the commonly used approaches are:

- Personal observation – watching customers, reading their body language and listening for comments they make about their experience
- Talking to customers – and asking targeted questions to identify things such as:
 - What they liked and didn't like about a destination
 - How the promotional message compared with the actual experience
 - Feedback about detailed aspects of a destination
 - Verification of information
 - What they would like to see us offer in addition to what we already provide
 - What we could stop offering
 - How we could improve what we currently offer to make it even better for future clients
 - The level of satisfaction with us and the destination
 - Suggested activities etc. that future clients may enjoy
- Asking customers to complete a written survey – that seeks information on issues of interest to the business
- Asking customers to complete a formal questionnaire
- Encouraging customer to give feedback and making it easy for customers to give feedback by, for example, encouraging online feedback, giving out 'Customer Suggestion' cards
- Conducting focus group sessions – where a representative cross-section of customers is brought together for an hour or so to discuss nominated service- and business-related topics.



Research and collect customer feedback forms

Activity 18

You are required to conduct internet research and identify two examples of templates of customer feedback forms that are provided to clients after they have returned from a travel experience.



Comparing information from different sources regarding the same destination

In order to validate the information provided by sources, it is often important to compare information about specific destinations, suppliers and products and services, through different sources.

For example you may wish to compare offerings about a specific destination, supplier or product and service via:

- Their brochures
- Online websites
- Supplier websites
- Direct contact.



This will help identify the consistency and accuracy of the message provided to customers.

Relating destination information to personal experience and knowledge

Naturally, any personal experiences that you have had at a destination will be the most beneficial tool in validating a destination against information provided through different sources.

Assessing source against criteria for capturing destination information

Each organisation may have established criteria in which they capture destination information.

These criteria, or checklists, are a sound basis for conducting an evaluation of an information source, or of an end product or service.

These criteria may include, but not limited to:

- Reliability of information and end suppliers and their products
- Ease of access
- Accuracy in comparison with other sources for identical destinations, products or services
- Accuracy of content compared with actual experiences
- Level of customer satisfaction.



Researching comments on websites



There are many travel websites where customers, most of which have not booked services through your organisation, are provided with the opportunity to provide online feedback about their experiences and to upload realistic photos.

This feedback is very valuable in understanding the reality of a destination.

Trip Advisor, an American travel website company, provides useful reviews of travel-related content. It also includes interactive travel forums which can also be beneficial tools for travel staff to accurately gauge the popularity and services provided by different tourism product and service providers.

Relevant websites providing comprehensive customer and professional reviews of different tourism destinations, supplies, products and services include, but certainly not limited to:

- www.tripadvisor.com
- www.oyster.com
- www.virtualtourist.com
- www.fodors.com
- www.raveable.com.





Research travel review websites

Activity 19

You are required to look at two different travel review websites and identify:

- Key features of the website
- The benefits of the website for customers and travel staff
- Possible downfalls of the website.

Website: _____

Key features of the website	
The benefits of the website for customers and travel staff	
Possible downfalls of the website	

Website: _____

Key features of the website	
The benefits of the website for customers and travel staff	
Possible downfalls of the website	

Ensure accurate and updated destination information

Not only is it important to ensure you are using reliable and accurate sources of information and end destination suppliers themselves, but the information gathered from them is accurate and up to date.

It is crucial to be aware the information for sites and locations never stays the same. It is always subject to change.

Given that the core of your role is to provide information to visitors it is essential that the information provided is current and accurate.

We will explore some methods that can be used to ensure the information provided to visitors is not only reliable and valuable, but is relevant to their needs.

A key aspect of providing current and accurate visitor information is the need for you to be proactive in not only obtaining it, but updating it on a regular basis.

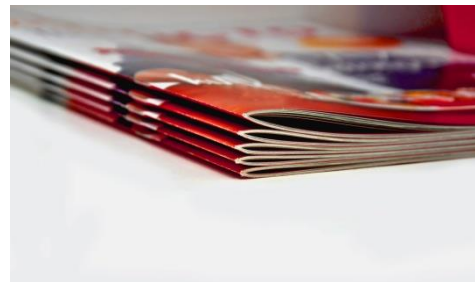
All staff should be alert to the opportunities to update their destination knowledge.

These opportunities include:

Observing expiry dates of information

This may include:

- Diarising dates when brochures etc. become out-of-date – so you are prompted to replace or remove them
- Read the information on each item – ‘Offer valid till XX/XX/20XX’; ‘only available until the end of October, 20XX’, ‘July – September 20XX’.



Looking up updates

- Look up the details on the supporting or relevant database – which may be the intranet, the CRS, with the supplier
- Ensuring fares quoted in brochures are consistent with organisational travel fare policies
- Obtaining current status reports which are used to advise clients – such as those relating to:
 - Weather
 - Currency exchange rates
 - Tourist alerts
- Reviewing organisation’s travel fare policies – to identify changes and determine how these impact the provision of travel information and advice to customers.

Read briefings of new information

These may be relating to:

- New sources of information
- New suppliers
- New review websites
- New or changed fares
- New packages and deals
- New or different destinations
- New or different services
- Altered schedules and connections
- New or different policies and procedures
- New or different terms and conditions.



Monitoring relevant industry trends and issues

In addition to ensuring your destination knowledge inventory is accurate and up to date, it is also important to keep up to date with industry issues and trends.

This is important as it means that you can offer new airlines, flight routes , attractions, hotels, destinations or experiences that become popular as they arise.

In addition, when problems occur in different countries for an endless number of reasons that may affect a travel experience, such as new visa requirements, new flight schedules, political unrest or unwelcomed weather patterns, customers can receive accurate information.

You should seek to identify and monitor a range of a wide range of issues such as:

- Changing and emerging trends
- Initiatives relating to advertising, marketing and promotion
- Market research information – which identifies the needs, wants and preferences of customers
- Trends and selling prices of the destinations and services being offered by both your business and elsewhere throughout the industry
- Activities the opposition is undertaking to attract customers or to meet competition in the market place.



Participating in local familiarisation tours

These are a brilliant way to find out about what destinations have to offer to visitors.

It is surprising how long a person can live in an area, and never go to the tourist attractions.

If you've never been to a destination you are promoting or discussing:

- How can you entice others?
- How can you sell the excitement, the ambience, the feeling?
- Where's your credibility?



Options for finding out about destinations include visiting these places yourself, or going as part of an organised tour. If you talk to the tour operator and tell them where you work and why you want to go, there is a very good chance you will be able to go free-of-charge because they will see the benefit of contributing towards an industry person who will be a potential source of business.

Another option is that you can organise a 'familiarisation tour' for all the staff at your workplace and visit destinations as tourists. This will then enable you to talk with authority and credibility to any and all customers about the places you have visited.

This will take a bit of time and effort to organise but it will reap mutual rewards and definitely shows people you are being proactive in your approach to local tourism.

Observing media

This can include:

- Television
- Internet
- Videos and films
- Radio
- Printed materials.



Because you can't be everywhere at once, the media is a useful source of information about destinations

Be prepared to factor in anything you learn to your existing file of knowledge.

Where an item appears and you aren't sure about it, take the time to follow up with the appropriate person and then update your file accordingly.

Getting on mailing lists

Whenever you identify a source of local visitor information you certainly need to obtain whatever information is available, but you should also register to be sent further updates as they occur.



Keeping up to date with industry trends and issues

Activity 20

You are required to identify five media sources that can be used to keep up to date with tourism trends and issues.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____



4.2 Evaluate methods of provision of destination information

4.3 Evaluate effectiveness of destination information provision

Introduction

In the previous section we looked at the reliability and accuracy of collecting destination information. Whilst this is vital, it is only one half of the information process.

In Section 3.2 we explored the different ways in which to share information with customers. It is also important to evaluate the methods that you use to provide information to clients.

Review methods of providing destination information

At times, it is important the review if the methods used to share information are the most appropriate to:

- Pass on destination information
- Ensures sufficient amount of information to make an informed decisions
- In a method or format that is user friendly to them
- Is understandable
- Encourages clients to make a purchase.



Methods used to evaluate methods and effectiveness of provisions

In the previous section we looked at a number of review methods, some of which will also apply to this section. That said, specific methods used to evaluate how we provide destination information to clients includes, but not limited to:

- Seeking feedback from clients on:
 - The utility of current methods
 - Satisfaction with information provided, including scope and content
- Identifying which methods are preferred by existing clients
- Identifying deficiencies in information provided
- Appraising new options
- Creating new areas for information provision
- Assessing methods used by the competition
- Revising current information provision methods on the basis of feedback and emerging options.





Activity 20

Identify criteria for evaluating provision and effectiveness of destination information

You are required to identify five questions / criteria you would ask customers to identify if the provision of destination information is suitable to their needs.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____



Activity 22

Identify methods to identify how tourism leaders provide destination information

You are required to conduct research and identify the methods used by leading tourism and travel organisations to provide destination information to their customers.

Describe the methods you used to identify this information.

4.4 Amend or confirm sources of destination information

Introduction

To date, this manual has explored different ways and sources in which to access, interpret, provide and review destination information to help meet the needs of the client.

Whilst it is essential that any information collected and used for analysis be relevant and current, it is also important to ensure:

- Appropriate sources and suppliers of information are used
- Appropriate types of destination information are used
- Information inventories are up-to-date.

Whilst this primarily mean continuous updating information relating to commonly used tourism destinations and services, it also relates to ensuring any destination information, such as, are still applicable, even if they are only given to clients sporadically.



Identifying suitable sources and suppliers of destination information

As seen in this manual to date, especially in Section 1.1 there are many suppliers of travel related tourism information, be it end users through to wholesales and industry associations.

It is essential that the sources of information meet the needs of the client and therefore the process of selecting suitable sources and suppliers of destination information includes;

- Identifying client requirements in terms of destination information
- Collecting information as to whom provides information relating to these products and services
- Identifying suitable suppliers or sources
- Assessing alternatives against the identified client requirements
- Accommodating host enterprise requirements in relation to the use of preferred suppliers, providers and carriers
- Aligning with established client preferences
- Confirm sources / suppliers of destination information.



Utilising different sources of destination information

In Section 1.1 of this manual many different sources of destination information have been identified.

As part of the process of evaluation process, it may have identified the need to amend or change the format of information to be provided.

Following are different examples of information that may be changed or confirmed.

Text-based information

Text based information is the most commonly used form of destination information for tourism businesses and includes:

- Brochures, flyers and pamphlets
- Destination manuals
- Supplier information and sales kits
- Confidential and general industry tariffs
- Preferred contracts or agreements
- Clue cards
- Fare sheets
- Industry publications, advices and notices
- Media articles
- Travel literature
- Travel guides
- Newspapers and magazines
- Timetables
- Reports
- Summaries
- Marketing materials and books.



Image-based material

Whilst images are often included in text based information, specific image based material can include:

- Photographs
- Recordings
- Videos
- Posters
- Atlases and maps.



Methods to monitor destination information inventory

This may include:

- Assessing completeness, accuracy and currency of the destination information
- Verifying source of information
- Monitoring bookings, allotments/allocations and requests
- Ensuring regular up-dates in accordance with supplier schedules and seasonal demands
- Ensuring all destinations and services offered are supported by suitable and sufficient destination information inventory.



Requesting additional destination information

Whilst you may have a scheduled time in which to replace and update brochures or minimum par level for when brochures need to be replenished, at times you will need to request additional allocations of brochures or other promotional materials.

There may be many reasons why there is a shortage of brochures, including but not limited to:

- One-off peak load demand
- General trends indicating increased demand
- New promotions and packages
- Increased media awareness for a location or business - whether in the news, current affairs, documentaries etc.
- Attractive offers by complementary businesses - for example recently promoted cheap flights might lead to greater demand to one of their destinations
- Greater ease of travel - regulatory restrictions may be relaxed
- Currency exchange fluctuations



Strategies for handling low levels of destination information inventory

When brochures for a particular destination are running low strategies include:

- Contacting the supplier for more copies
- Keep a 'staff copy' and give selected printed pages to clients
- Refer them to the company website
- Arrange printing of brochures at current location
- Ask supplier to send copies of brochures, including any new promotions or news, directly to the client
- Provide information of similar properties in the region.



Remove destination information

As part of destination inventory management, it is essential that any 'outdated' or inaccurate copies of brochures or information be removed immediately.

As discussed before in previous sections, the consequences of providing inaccurate information can have detrimental consequences for all parties involved.

Methods to remove information

This may relate to:

- Deleting information regarding destinations and services that have been removed from the service menu
- Over-writing dated information with revised information
- Removing out-of-date information
- Complying with designated host enterprise guidelines
- Removing hard copy material that supports and reflects destination information inventory data.



Meeting needs of destination supplier when removing information

- Whilst each organisation will have their own guidelines for disposing of outdated destination information, it is important to also remember the needs and guidelines of the destination supplier as well
- It is important to ensure that outdated information be 'disposed' in a manner that meets the needs of the destination supplier
- It is a good idea to contact them to identify what they want done with their brochures. Primarily they will want to ensure that potential clients do not have access or contact with out-dated information
- If by chance, people do actually obtain an outdated copy, given that they may contain promotions or information no longer valid, it is essential that they understand that they no longer apply
- Supplier may want outdated copies to be:
 - Returned to them
 - Shredded or destroyed
 - Marked in a manner that identifies them as invalid or outdated
 - Placed in normal waste
 - Recycled in line in with organisational values.



Update destination information

In a number of cases whilst the bulk of information in a brochure may be relevant, aspects of them may need to be updated or changed.

For most destination suppliers, the process of reproducing and transporting new brochures to travel operators globally is a very expensive and resource dependant activity. Therefore when small updates are required, they may ask travel agents to include 'additions' or make 'amendments' to current brochures.

Reasons for updates

Whilst the reasons for updating promotional destination information may be endless, common reasons include:

- Price changes
- Changes to destinations and services
- New packages
- Updated facilities
- New attractions
- Changes in visa requirements
- New management
- New awards
- Stories of interest
- New agreements with partner organisations.



Input up-dates and other destination information

Ways in which destination information can be updated include:

- Adding new information as soon as possible to ensure currency of destination information inventory
- Ensuring related hard copy material is removed or amended, including promotional material and hard copy information used by staff for selling activities
- Updated with new promotional information or pages
- Amended by removing selected pages
- Ensuring accuracy of data entry.





Identify need to replenish, remove or update destination inventory

Activity 23

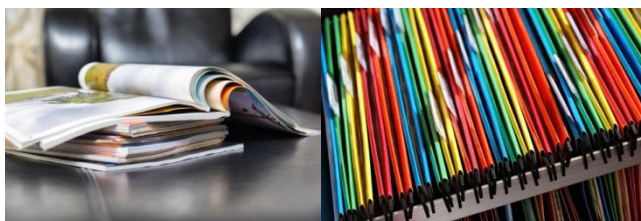
You are required to interview a travel agency to identify the processes they follow to ensure their destination knowledge inventory is managed including:

- Having sufficient adequate stock levels
- Handling low stock levels
- Requesting additional stock allocations
- Ensuring outdated stock is removed
- Ensuring stock items are updated or amended.



Company Name:	
Contact Person:	
How do they ensure they have sufficient adequate stock levels?	
What are reasons why their stock levels may be in high demand?	
How do they handle low stock level situations?	

What are the methods used to request additional stock allocations?	
How do they remove outdated stock?	
What are some guidelines suppliers may have in relation to the removal of outdated brochures?	
How do they ensure stock items are updated or amended?	
What are activities performed to update or amend supplier brochures?	



Review presentation of destination information inventory

Hard copy information

Given that the presentation of brochures, quotations and other related travel materials are the most commonly used mechanisms to explain and promote destinations, it is important to review how these are presented to clients.

This includes ensuring:

- Materials are presented in the order and manner identified as being best for the business and the clients
- Sufficient quantities of materials are available
- All materials are current featuring up-to-date schedules and prices
- All materials are free of errors and there are no omissions.



Electronic materials

In addition to the maintenance of hard copy destination information, it is just as important to review how information is provided through electronic means.

This includes the use of:

- Internet websites
- Electronic brochures
- Social media sites
- Electronic information templates.

As can be seen in this manual, the sourcing, supply, explanation and management of destination information is quite complex and always requiring attention.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

4.1 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 18,19,20

4.2 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 21,22

4.3 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activities 21,22

4.4 Please complete the following activities relating to this Performance Criteria:

- Activity 23
-

Summary

Review provision of destination knowledge

Evaluate sources of destination information

- Importance of evaluating sources of information
- Strategies for evaluating sources of information
- Ensure accurate and updated destination information.

Evaluate methods of provision of destination information

Evaluate effectiveness of destination information provision

- Review methods of providing destination information
- Methods used to evaluate methods and effectiveness of provisions.

Amend or confirm sources of destination information

- Identifying suitable sources and suppliers of destination information
- Utilising different sources of destination information
- Methods to monitor destination information inventory
- Requesting additional destination information
- Remove destination information
- Update destination information
- Review presentation of destination information inventory.

Presentation of written work

1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final destination will be well organised. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognise and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

3. Presenting Written Work

Types of written work

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



Format

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

Cover Sheet

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class/unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

Keeping a Copy

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

Inclusive language

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

Mankind	<i>Humankind</i>
Barman/maid	<i>Bar attendant</i>
Host/hostess	<i>Host</i>
Waiter/waitress	<i>Waiter or waiting staff</i>

Recommended reading

Bhatia, A; 2012 (1st edition); *The Business of Travel Agency & Tour Operations Management*; Sterling Publishers

Booth, Wayne; 2008 (3rd edition); *The Craft of Research*; University Of Chicago Press

Buhalis, Dimitrios; 2003 (1st edition); *eTourism: Information technology for strategic tourism management*; Prentice Hall

Chon, Kaye Sung & Edgell Sr, David; 2006 (1st edition); *Managing Sustainable Tourism: A Legacy for the Future*; Routledge

Conrady, Roland & Buck, Martin; 2011 (1st edition); *Trends and Issues in Global Tourism*, Springer Publishers

Cook, Roy 2009 (4th Edition); *The Business of Travel*; Prentice Hall

Goeldner Charles R. 2011 (12th edition); *Tourism: Principles, Practices, Philosophies*; Wiley

Hall, Colin Michael; 2008 (1st edition); *Tourism Planning: Policies, Processes and Relationships*; Pearson/Prentice Hall

Lennon, John; 2003 (1st edition); *Tourism Statistics: International Perspectives and Current Issues*; Cengage Learning EMEA;

Mason, Peter; 2008 (2nd edition); *Tourism Impacts, Planning and Management*; Taylor & Francis

Molz , Jennie Germann ; 2012 (1st edition); *Travel Connections: Tourism; Technology and Togetherness in a Mobile World*, Routledge

Rastogi, A; 2007 (1st edition); *Travel Agency Operations*; Aman Publications

Sharma, Lalita; 2010 (1st edition); *Travel Agency and Tour Operation: Concepts and Principles*; Centrum Press

Sharpley, Richard, 2002 (1st edition); *Tourism and development – concepts and issues*; Channel view publications

Smith, Maureen A. & Schloss, Patrick J; 1999 (1st edition); *Conducting Research*; Prentice Hall

Walker, John R and Walker, Josielyn; 2010 (1st edition); *Tourism: Concepts and Practices*; Prentice Hall

Weaver, David; 2005 (1st edition); *Sustainable Tourism*; Taylor & Francis

Yeoman, Ian; 2008 (1st edition); *Tomorrow's Tourist – Scenarios and Trends*; Future Foundation

Zhou, Zongqing; 2003 (1st edition); *E-Commerce and Information Technology in Hospitality and Tourism*; Delmar Cengage Learning

Destination information can be sourced through:

- The series of 'Lonely Planet' books as applicable to individual countries
- Various city guides
- Trip Advisors.

Online Travel Guides:

- Arrivalguides.com
- Concierge.com
- Fodor's
- Frommers.com
- Let's Go Travel Guides
- Lonely Planet
- Rough Guides
- Ruba
- Traveldk.com
- Trip Advisor
- Tripwolf
- Wikitravel
- Yahoo Travel.

Trainee evaluation sheet

Source and provide destination information and advice

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

Please tick the appropriate box	Agree	Don't Know	Do Not Agree	Does Not Apply
There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency was at the right level for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I got enough help from my trainer.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The amount of activities was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training was well-organised.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer had time to answer my questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understood how I was going to be assessed.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was given enough time to practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer feedback was useful.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enough equipment was available and it worked well.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The activities were too hard for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐

The best things about this unit were:

The worst things about this unit were:

The things you should change in this unit are:

Trainee self-assessment checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer/Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer/Assessor.

Source and provide destination information and advice

		Yes	No*
Element 1: Generate initial destination knowledge			
1.1	Identify sources of destination information	☐	☐
1.2	Describe criteria for capturing destination information	☐	☐
1.3	Identify client needs relating to destination information that may be required	☐	☐
1.4	Research destination information	☐	☐
1.5	Capture and record and classify destination and general destination information	☐	☐
Element 2: Update destination knowledge			
2.1	Register to receive updated destination information	☐	☐
2.2	Integrate updated information into existing destination information	☐	☐
2.3	Initiate new files for new information and/or new destinations	☐	☐
Element 3: Communicate destination knowledge			
3.1	Identify client and colleague needs relating to destination information that is required	☐	☐
3.2	Share destination information	☐	☐
3.3	Advise clients in relation to information about specific destinations	☐	☐
3.4	Present hard copy information to clients	☐	☐
Element 4: Review provision of destination knowledge			
4.1	Evaluate sources of destination information	☐	☐
4.2	Evaluate methods of provision of destination information	☐	☐
4.3	Evaluate effectiveness of destination information provision	☐	☐
4.4	Amend or confirm sources of destination information	☐	☐

Statement by Trainee:

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

Signed: _____

Date: _____

Note:

For all boxes where a **No*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.

